

The Noble Sūtra Called the Secret Jewel-Dot

Āryaguhyamaṇḍitakā nāma sūtra · Toh 493 · Derge Kangyur

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Toh 493 in the Kangyur is a sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Āryaguhyamaṇḍitakā and in Tibetan as the Phags pa gsang ba nor bu thig le, rendered in English as the Noble Sūtra Called the Secret Jewel-Dot. It belongs to the tantric-inflected sūtra literature of the Kangyur, situated among texts with a strongly Vajrayāna character, and opens with an elaborate description of the Buddha Vairocana enthroned in his role as the Dharma King of the three realms, invested with the samaya-wisdom and mudrās of all Tathāgatas. The text's imagery of vajra consecration, crown empowerment, and the boundless compassion of the All-Illuminating one places it squarely within the esoteric doctrinal world shared by Mahāyāna and Vajrayāna traditions. As Toh 493 in the Kangyur, it is preserved as part of the canonical scriptural heritage transmitted into Tibetan Buddhism.

In the language of India: Āryaguhyamaṇḍitakā nāma sūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Sūtra Called the Secret Jewel-Dot.

I bow with reverence at the dust of the feet of my Lama and of Mañjuśrī, whose feet leave no stain.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata — possessed of the vajra-consecrated samaya-wisdom of all the Tathāgatas in its manifold supremely exalted forms; having received the jewel crown empowerment of all the Tathāgatas as the Dharma King of the three realms; performing manifold deeds through having perfectly assimilated all the mudrās of all the Tathāgatas; fulfilling every aspiration of the entire realm of sentient beings without remainder; the form of great compassion, Vairocana (the "All-Illuminating"), the eternal body abiding in the samayas of the three times; the great precious jewel of the vajra body, speech, and mind of all the Tathāgatas, attended and praised by all the Tathāgatas — was dwelling in a many-storied palace at the peak of a great and precious jewel, possessed of bells of brilliant and variegated colors, silk pennants moved by the wind, garlands of flowers, nets, half-nets, and the beautiful palace of the king of the gods of Akaniṣṭha (the highest heaven), adorned nearby by the moon.

He was together with nine hundred ninety million bodhisattvas, namely: the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, Avalokiteśvara the Powerful, Ākāśagarbha, Vajramuṣṭi, the one possessed of the generation of the awakening mind who excellently

turns the wheel of Dharma, Gaṇḍāmṛtakoṣa, the Destroyer of All the Powers of Māra, Mañjuśrī Kumārabhūta, the bodhisattva Samantabhadra — and these and other nine hundred ninety million bodhisattvas; and immeasurable, uncountable Tathāgatas numerous as the grains of sand of the Ganges River, who beheld Jambudvīpa as though filled completely with sesame seeds. From each one of those Tathāgatas' bodies they saw immeasurable, incalculable Tathāgata pure lands, and in all those buddha fields this very same Dharma teaching was being given.

Then the Blessed One Vairocana — ever abiding in the vajra body, speech, and mind throughout all reaches of space; the wisdom being who has thoroughly comprehended in mind all the vajra-realms traversed by all the Tathāgatas; arisen from the dust-vajra blessing of all the reaches of space, the essential wisdom radiating by its very nature throughout all reaches of space; one who directly and fully knows the wisdom of all the Tathāgatas; by the purity of the self-nature of all the Tathāgatas, seeing well with wisdom all forms that are pure in essential nature and pervade all of space, supreme in conduct for taming the entire realm of sentient beings without exception; endowed with the wisdom deeds of purposeful activity of all the Tathāgatas; the great awakening mind of all the Tathāgatas; the lord of wisdom possessed of the samaya of summoning all Tathāgatas and the wisdom of all Tathāgatas' loving engagement; the excellence of all the Tathāgatas; the precious jewel empowered by the great precious jewel of all the Tathāgatas; and the maṇḍala of the sunbeams of all the Tathāgatas —

the precious jeweled pinnacle of the great wish-fulfilling jewel of all the Tathāgatas; the great laughter of all the Tathāgatas; the Dharma of the great purity of all the Tathāgatas; the wisdom and great primordial wisdom of all the Tathāgatas; the great wheel of all the Tathāgatas; the great vajra-speech of all the Tathāgatas; the manifold karmic activities of all the Tathāgatas; the protection of all the Tathāgatas; the vajra-yakṣa who is utterly sustained and guarded by all the Tathāgatas; and endowed with the wisdom of the mudrā of all mudrās — the enlightened intention of the vajra body, speech, and mind of all the Tathāgatas:

Samantabhadra, the purposeful one,
the chief of immortal, supreme delight,
Ākāśagarbha, great in splendor,
the jeweled pinnacle, the great smiling one,
Avalokiteśvara, the Great Lord,

Mañjuśrī, the essence of all,
who holds the manifold activity beyond words,
the fierce hero who holds firmly,
the vajra hook, the arrow's satisfaction,
the jeweled sun, the victorious banner's smile,
the Dharma treasury, the beautiful wheel-voice,
who holds karma, Dharma, and the terrifying,
without beginning or end, the peaceful,
wrathful toward the intractable, greatly patient,
firm in the excellence of yakṣas and rākṣasas,
greatly glorious hero, the all-pervading lord,
lord of Umā, protector of all beings,
the great capable one who conquers, possessing life and wish,
sustainer of the world, of sky and earth,
of the three worlds and the three realms,
who supremely fulfills the aims of the great elements and sentient beings,
the great father of all sentient beings,
to be contemplated as saṃsāra and nirvāṇa,
the true ocean and the great offering,
the purity of buddhas, the Great Vehicle,
and the three existences as well —

seated in that great maṇḍala and teaching the Dharma, he was surrounded by many hundreds of thousands of millions of bodhisattvas possessing many hundreds of thousands of millions of such qualities and more.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, resting on a lunar maṇḍala in the presence of the Blessed One Vairocana, the lord of all the Tathāgatas, addressed the Blessed One who is without beginning or end: "O Blessed One, please speak the special meditative absorption called the Drop of the Supreme Great Secret. By this I shall explain to sentient beings the samaya of the suchness of the secret."

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, lord of all the Tathāgatas, spoke thus to Vajrapāṇi, the lord of secrets: "Vajrapāṇi, lord of secrets, explain that by which all sentient beings will certainly attain unsurpassed, genuinely perfect awakening."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi again addressed the Blessed One: "O Blessed One, lord of all the Tathāgatas, please declare that by which I become the lord of secrets."

Thereupon all those Tathāgatas entered into the heart of the Blessed One Vairocana. Then the Blessed One, the lord of all the Tathāgatas, made all those Tathāgatas inseparable, and having made all those Tathāgata bodies inseparable, he addressed that very Blessed One Vajrasattva with this proclamation:

How wondrous — I myself, through great skillful means,
accomplish the meditative absorption
of the supremely secret drop,
and yet still ask about the secret itself.

Then the Blessed One, the great Samantabhadra, emerged from the heart of the Blessed One and stood at his side, and once again addressed the Blessed One with these words: "O Blessed One, what is this supremely secret drop?"

Thereupon the Blessed One, the lord of all the Tathāgatas, addressed the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi with these words: "O Vajrapāṇi, this supremely secret drop is utterly secret, profoundly secret. It gives rise to all Tathāgatas. It bestows the very nature of all Tathāgatas. It makes all Tathāgatas steadfast. It enters into the heart of all Tathāgatas for the purpose of experiencing the bliss and mental joy of all Tathāgatas. It is the father of all Tathāgatas. It is the mother of all Tathāgatas. It is the treasury of secrets. It itself is the lotus. It itself is the vajra. It itself is the sacred pledge — and therefore, Vajrapāṇi, one must not speak of it before those who do not know the sacred pledge. That is why I have not taught it to anyone whatsoever."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi once again addressed the Blessed One with these words: "O Blessed One, then for whose sake should it be spoken at all?"

Thereupon the Blessed One Vairocana bestowed the word of approval upon the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, declaring "Excellent!" and spoke these verses:

Excellent, O Vajrasattva, you!
O Vajra-jewel, well done to you!
Excellent, O Vajra-Dharma, you!
O Vajra-karma, supremely excellent!
This sūtra is well proclaimed —

the unsurpassed Vajra Vehicle,
the secret of all Tathāgatas,
the Great Vehicle in summary form.
By accomplishing it with pure intent alone,
buddhahood is easily attained,
and inexhaustible, unending bliss
is brought to fulfillment in this very life.

O Vajrapāṇi, therefore this Great Vehicle sūtra — called the Supremely Secret, which surpasses even the supremely secret drop — must be carefully concealed. Among sentient beings, some approach it with trepidation, while others, endowed with faith, have mounted the great elephant of the Great Vehicle. To those who are just beginning, neither the secret mantras nor the mudrās nor any of the secrets are to be taught or revealed. To those with faith who have received empowerment in the great maṇḍala, all of these are to be taught. This drop of the well-concealed meditative absorption — the supremely secret — is to be taught to a master who truly abides in supreme secrecy. Whoever, upon merely hearing this tantra proclaimed, follows it with faith, and whoever gives rise to the most intense joy — know that such beings have been prophesied by the buddhas of the past. To those, the instructions complete with oral guidance are to be taught with effort. But to sentient beings who belong to the Vehicle of the hearers, not even a bare account is to be given.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi again addressed the Blessed One with these words: "O Blessed One, why must not even a bare account be given to them?"

Thereupon the Blessed One, the lord of all the Tathāgatas, addressed Vajrapāṇi with these words: "O Vajrapāṇi, listen. Those sentient beings have not seen the divine rank and they utterly revile the sacred pledge. If it were spoken to them, even a bare account alone would cause them to fall headlong into hell."

Thereupon Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"O Blessed One, I too shall with this vajra, blazing and utterly ablaze, its flames become a single fire, burn all families. O Blessed One, I shall bring about the untimely death of those beings."

Then once more the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words: "O Blessed One, since I shall not speak of these matters among those of the Vehicle of the hearers, may the Blessed One therefore please declare this great maṇḍala, the essence of the Great Vehicle, known as the Drop of the Supremely Secret, for the sake of generating all happiness and mental ease, as long as the sacred pledge endures."

Thereupon the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, lord of all the Tathāgatas, by means of the meditative absorption called the heroic engagement of joyous exertion, unified all those Tathāgatas into one. Then the Blessed One, the lord of all the Tathāgatas, arose from that absorption and entered into meditative equipoise in the many distinct absorptions of the sacred pledge vajra called the Inviting of All Tathāgatas. For the sake of generating happiness and mental ease, for the sake of drawing in without remainder or residue the entire realm of sentient beings by means of the complete sacred pledge of inviting all the Tathāgatas, and for the sake of accomplishing the supreme absorption, he declared to the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: the extensive ritual that has been condensed from the vast array of individual methods of accomplishment.

First of all, the practitioner of mantra is to visualize in a lunar maṇḍala within both hands the form of the syllable A. That form of the syllable A is white in color and of an unstained nature, having the character of nectar; and from that very thing fully transformed arises the lunar maṇḍala.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, having been established in the lunar maṇḍala of the southern direction, addressed the Blessed One, lord of all the Tathāgatas: "O Blessed One, why should both hands be regarded as a lunar maṇḍala?"

Thereupon the Blessed One, the lord of all the Tathāgatas, entered into meditative equipoise in the absorption called the Accomplishment of All the Sacred Excellences of the Tathāgatas and declared to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: "Here, a small white vajra of the measure of a sesame seed, luminous with rays of light, is to be meditated upon in both hands upon the moon by means of this mantra: HŪṂ."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi again addressed the Blessed One: "O Blessed One, how shall I seek it? What shall be done with that vajra?"

Thereupon the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, spoke these words to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, listen. Joining the palms of the hands firmly as a vajra mudrā, one is to release it at the crown of one's own head with this secret

mantra: OM SVABHĀVAŚUDDHĀḤ SARVADHARMĀḤ SVABHĀVAŚUDDHO
'HAM."

Then the practitioner is to meditate upon oneself in the form of pure crystal,
unstained and luminous by nature. Then, taking up the vow, one prays: "May
all the buddhas and bodhisattvas attend to me. I, called so-and-so, from this
moment forth until I reach the very heart of awakening:

Just as the lords of the three times
have utterly resolved upon awakening,
so too the supreme awakening mind,
unsurpassed, shall I arouse.

The training in moral discipline,
the gathering of virtuous qualities,
and working for the benefit of beings —
these three aspects of moral discipline
I shall each severally hold fast.

The Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha —

the Three Jewels unsurpassed,
the vow born of the yoga of buddhas —
from this day forth I shall hold firm.

The vajra, the bell, and the mudrā
I shall severally take up and hold.

The masters too I shall take up and hold.

To the supreme great family of the vajra
I shall ever give the fourfold gift.

Each day, in the six periods,
the pledge of yoga in the great precious family
shall be pleasing to my mind.

Born of the great awakening,
to the pure great lotus family,
the three vehicles — outer, inner, and secret —
the sacred Dharma I shall severally hold.

To the supreme great family of action,
complete in all vows,
these I shall severally take up and hold.

Through acts of offering, to the utmost of my ability,

for the supreme great family of action
the awakening mind unsurpassed and supreme
I shall fully arouse.

And for the sake of every sentient being,
I shall take up all vows without exception.

Those not yet liberated, I shall liberate.

Those not yet freed, I shall free.

Those not yet breathing easy, I shall give ease,
and I shall establish sentient beings in nirvāṇa.

Then the Blessed One Vairocana, lord of all tathāgatas, declared to the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: Having taken up the vow and abided in the great seal, the mantra practitioner shall meditate on all phenomena as selfless. Let one firmly set in one's heart that none of all these things whatsoever, outer or inner, subsists apart from what is examined by conceptual thought. And let one proclaim: All formations are impermanent and luminous by nature, unborn from the very beginning.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, seated upon a moon disc before the Blessed One, made this request: Blessed One, I pray you speak a little on how one meditates on the mind as luminous by nature.

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, lord of all tathāgatas, entered the meditative absorption called King of Individual Recognition of Mind, and declared to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: Vajrapāṇi, that mind luminous by nature — you should meditate on it as follows. Its identity is a moon disc; it is a beautiful disc of light pervading the entire expanse of space without remainder, extending more than a hundred thousand leagues. It is formed from the transformation of the syllables of the vowel series beginning with A: A, Ā, I, Ī, U, Ū, Ṛ, Ṝ, Ḍ, Ḍ̄, E, AI, O, AU, Aṃ, Aḥ. From the complete transformation of these, one should meditate on the form of the moon disc.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, having meditated on himself as having the form of a moon disc, beheld himself as having the form of a moon disc. Thereupon he came to rest upon the moon disc to the left of the Blessed One and dwelt in the form of Amoghasiddhi. Then, resting within the heart of the Blessed One Vairocana, he gave voice to this utterance:

How wondrous! I who am the purposefully accomplished one
of all the buddhas, accomplished from beginningless time —

just as I am a moon disc,
so I abide as a moon disc myself.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, resting upon the moon disc behind the Blessed One, made this request to the Blessed One, the great Vairocana: How should one behold that moon disc?

Then the Blessed One, lord of all tathāgatas, entered the meditative absorption called the Moon of Great Awakening of All Tathāgatas, and caused all the tathāgatas — filling world-systems to the farthest reaches, leaving none out — to enter his own heart. Having entered, they became indivisibly one and undivided.

It abides in the manner of fully pervading the entire expanse of space.

Vajrapāṇi, the great bodhisattva, the Awakening Moon — that moon is to be explained. Upon that moon, one should meditate on oneself in the manner of the Awakening Moon: the supreme form utterly free of stain, comparable to space, abandoning all conceptual thought; fully liberated from all unfavorable existences; for the purpose of experiencing all happiness and mental joy; and, for as long as space endures, like the moon seen before as stainless — entering into the qualities of buddhahood through forms such as the syllable ka and so forth:

ka kha ga gha ṇa, ca cha ja jha ña, ṭa ṭha ḍa ḍha ṇa, ta tha da dha na, pa pha ba bha ma, ya ra la va, śa ṣa sa ha, a ṃ kṣaḥ.

These syllables, beginning with ka, enter into forms such as stars and the rest, becoming indivisibly one — from that arising, one should conceive the very maṇḍala of the moon disc.

Furthermore, Vajrapāṇi, upon that moon maṇḍala, one should meditate on a five-pointed vajra (Skt. vajra), peaceful and radiant with rays of light, of a measure that fully pervades the entire expanse of space.

Then the lord of secrets, Vajrapāṇi, made this request to the Blessed One: Blessed One, how should I meditate on that vajra?

Then the Blessed One, Vairocana, lord of all tathāgatas, entered the meditative absorption called the Bodhisattva Vajra of All Tathāgatas, and having made it one with all the tathāgatas, declared to the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi:

Vajrapāṇi, that vajra is to be meditated upon in the form of the Bodhisattva Vajra — blazing with a vajra of a measure that fully pervades the entire expanse of space, adorned with all ornaments, one's whole body suffused and clear in the manner of reflected images of the buddhas, the left hand holding a bell, the right hand resting the vajra upon the heart, the face slightly smiling — thus should one meditate.

Then again the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi: The mantra is this:

oṃ vajra ātmako 'haṃ.

Then again the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi: Thereafter, that form of the Bodhisattva Vajra should be meditated upon as the body of a tathāgata, reciting and meditating with this mantra:

oṃ yathā sarvatathāgatās tathā ahaṃ.

Then from the syllable suṃ, one should meditate on Mount Meru, and place the syllable suṃ at the upper and lower gates. Then from the syllable hūṃ, one should meditate on a many-storied palace:

Four-sided with four gateways,
fully endowed with blazing vajras,
graced with a variety of colors,
beautified by pillars of manifold kinds,
adorned with lattice upon lattice,
thrust through with half-moons upon half-moons,
beautified by strings of jewels and pearls,
gathered together with numerous precious ornaments, silks, banners, and
bundles of flowers —
this palace, surpassing all through qualities such as these, one should
meditate on while reciting.

Then, having made oneself Vairocana, one should again meditate on oneself in the form of the Bodhisattva Vajra — through the union of reflected images, visualized as utterly filled with all the tathāgatas and adorned with garlands of vajras. Then, by means of that very syllable hūṃ, one should meditate on a moon maṇḍala at the heart of the body of the Bodhisattva Vajra. After that, one arranges the syllables of the Bodhisattva Vajra; and from the Bodhisattva Vajra together with those syllables becoming fully complete, one should meditate on a five-pointed vajra, peaceful and white.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One, saying: "Blessed One, how should one meditate on that vajra?"

Thereupon the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "From the complete transformation of that vajra, one should meditate on the manifold vajra."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I have grasped the manifold vajra."

Thereupon the Blessed One Vairocana entered into the meditative absorption called "Vajra That Arouses All Tathāgatas," and declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, listen. That very vajra, radiant with rays of light, with a slightly smiling countenance in the form of the Bodhisattva Vajra, its two hands brandishing a vajra, crowned with the diadem of the five buddhas — above it abides the Lord of all Tathāgatas; near the brow is Akṣobhya; to the right is Ratnasambhava; behind is Amitābha; and at the left side is Amoghasiddhi. One should meditate in the form of the Bodhisattva Vajra, endowed with such distinctive excellent qualities."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, having arisen in the form of such a Bodhisattva Vajra, sat once more in the presence of the Blessed One and spoke to him thus: "Blessed One, I see myself in the form of the Bodhisattva Vajra."

Thereupon the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, bestowed approval upon the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, saying: "Excellent! Excellent, O Vajrasattva! Excellent, O vajra and jewel! Excellent, O vajra and Dharma! Excellent, O vajra and action! This sūtra is well spoken — the unsurpassed vajra vehicle, kept secret by all Tathāgatas, the express summary of the Great Vehicle."

Then the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, the great Vairocana, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, everything shall be explained to you."

Next, with palms joined and vajra extended, one should generate the descent of the vajra upon Vajrapāṇi with this mantra:

oṃ vajra āveśa āveśa āḥ

Then, having generated the descent of the vajra, one should bind the Bodhisattva Vajra and proclaim the sacred pledge:

samaya stvaṃ

Then, having given the pledge, one should recite the hundred-syllable mantra:
oṃ tiṣṭha vajre dṛḍho me bhava, anurakto me bhava, suṭoṣyo me bhava,
śāśvato me bhava, hṛdayaṃ me adhiṭiṣṭha, sarva siddhim me prayaccha,
sarva karma su ca me cittaṃ śreyaḥ kuru hūṃ, ha ha ha ha hoḥ, bhagavān
sarva tathāgato vajra mā me muñca vajrī bhava vajrasattva āḥ

Then, with a vajra fist, one should place a vajra flower on the crown of the head with this mantra:

pratīccha vajra hoḥ

The mantrin should then visualize that flower as a garland. Next, taking up that garland, one should bind it to the crown of the head with this mantra:

oṃ pratigṛhṇatvaṃ imaṃ sattva mahābala

Then one should regard that garland as the very essence of all Tathāgatas.

Next, one should perform the opening of the eyes with this mantra:

oṃ vajrasattva svayante āryacakṣur ghaṭana tata par unghaṭayate sarva
cakṣu vajracakṣur anuttare he vajrapāśya

Then, if one sees all the Tathāgatas and all the bodhisattvas abiding in the midst of space, one should know that accomplishment has been attained. If one sees only a luminous appearance, even that signifies one has drawn near to attainment.

Then, with perfumed water blessed by the vajra, the mantrin should confer empowerment upon himself with this mantra:

vajra abhiṣiñca. Then one should snap the fingers three times and clap, reciting: vajra tuṣya hoḥ. Then one should take up the vajra with this mantra:
oṃ ārya abhiṣekatāstvaṃ, si buddhe vajra abhiṣekatā idaṃ te sarva buddha
tvam grhṇa vajrāṃ susiddhaye. Then Vajrasattva should be displayed as oneself, or as a Tathāgata.

If one is to become an ācārya, one should then confer empowerment upon oneself with the samaya mudrā and this mantra: oṃ vajra adhibhavati tvam abhiṣiñcāmi tiṣṭha vajra samaya stvaṃ. Then one confers empowerment upon oneself with this mudrā and mantra: oṃ vajrasattva tvāṃ abhiṣiñcāmi vajra nāma abhiṣekata he vajra nāma — and here one should recite the name of the bodhisattva whose name the student has received.

Then, to establish the student firmly, one recites:

This, which is all the buddhas,
abides in the hand of Vajrasattva.
You too should always hold it:
remain steadfast in the conduct of Vajrasattva.

Then one should generate the descent of the suchness of all accomplishments with this mantra: om̐ sarva tathāgata siddhi, vajra eṣa tvāṃ dhārayāmi vajrasattva hi hi hi hi hūṃ hoḥ. Then one should recite the samaya of Vajrasattva over oneself: om̐ mahāsattva samaya stvaṃ haṃ.

Then, having thus been blessed, one should recite once again the Hundred-Syllable mantra: om̐ tiṣṭha vajra samaya stvaṃ, samaya sattva āḥ, dṛḍho me bhava, supoṣyo me bhava, anurakto me bhava, śāśvato me bhava, hṛdayaṃ me adhiṭṭha sarva siddhi me prayaccha, sarva karma su ca me cittaṃ śreyaḥ kuru hūṃ, ha ha ha ha hoḥ, bhagavān sarva tathāgata vajra mā me muñca vajrī bhava vajrasattva āḥ.

Then once more, in the manner of Vajrasattva, with the bell in the left hand and the vajra placed at the heart in the right hand, one should meditate on everything just as before. Through that sequence of meditation, one will attain the state of Vajrasattva itself, or the state of a Tathāgata itself.

For all meditative absorptions and all recitations of joyful hymns, the mantrin should from the very beginning practice meditation in this way. This completes the chapter on individual awareness of mind and so forth, as it is extensively set forth in the King of Tantras called the Great Secret, the Vajratilaka.

Then the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, abiding in that moon-disk maṇḍala, entered into the meditative absorption of the hero. From the hearts of all the Tathāgatas, Vajrasattva, Vajrapāṇi, and the rest, they all emerged. Thereafter all those Tathāgatas offered this prayer of one hundred and eight names to the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, who is without beginning and without end:

Homage and praise to Vajrapāṇi —
Vajrasattva, great bodhisattva,
Vajra-Tathāgata of all vajras,
primordial vajra, Samantabhadra.

Homage and praise to Vajra-Hook —
Vajra King of excellent intellect,
Vajra-Hook Tathāgata,

Meaningful King, supreme vajra.

Homage and praise to Vajra-Bow —
Vajra Passion of great bliss,
Vajra Arrow that subjugates,
Great Desire, great vajra.

Homage and praise to Vajra Joy —
Vajrasattva, supreme great bodhisattva,
Vajra Satiation of great delight,
King of Supreme Joy, sovereign vajra.

Homage and praise to Vajra Essence —
Vajra Jewel of excellent supreme aim,
Vajra Sky, great celestial gem,
Vajra Wealthy One, essence of space.

Homage and praise to Vajra Lamp —
Vajra Splendor blazing brilliantly,
Vajra Sun, radiance of the Victor,
Vajra Ray of great magnificence.

Homage and praise to your vajra form —
Vajra Crest, supremely benefiting beings,
Vajra Victory Banner of perfect fulfillment,
Vajra Pinnacle, great vajra.

Vajra Laughter, resounding greatly,
Vajra Smile, wondrously marvelous —

Rejoicing and supremely delighting — Vajra Supreme One,
homage and praise to you, Vajra Delight.
Vajra Dharma, greatly benefiting sentient beings,
Vajra Lotus, perfectly pure,
Vajra Eye of Īśvara (the Lord of the World) —
homage and praise to you, Vajra Eye.
Vajra Sharp Blade of the Great Vehicle,
Vajra Treasury, great weapon,
Mañjuśrī Vajra, profoundly deep —
homage and praise to you, Vajra Intelligence.
Vajra Cause, great essential nature,

Vajra Wheel of great excellence,
supremely turning, born from the vajra —
homage and praise to you, Vajra Ornament.
Vajra Speaker of most excellent lineage,
Vajra Recitation, prayer for perfect accomplishment,
Silent Vajra of supreme attainment —
homage and praise to you, Vajra Speech.
Vajra Action supreme, marked by the vajra,
Karma Vajra, beautiful in all movement,
Vajra of Meaningful Purpose, vast and expansive —
homage and praise to you, Vajra of Variety.
Vajra Protection, greatly steadfast,
Vajra Dharma, supremely hard,
most excellent hero who is very difficult to contest —
homage and praise to you, Vajra Diligence.
Vajra Yakṣa of great skillful means,
Vajra Fang, supremely terrifying,
Thundering Vajra that utterly subdues the māras —
homage and praise to you, Vajra Fierce One.
Vajra Boundary, excellently approached,
Vajra Binding, supremely liberating,
Vajra Fist of supreme sacred commitment —
homage and praise to you, Vajra Fist.

Whosoever holds this virtue of your one hundred and eight names — the empowerment of the vajra name and so forth — is empowered by the supreme ones of all.

One who constantly praises with melodious song through these names, which constitute an assembly of qualities of the Great Vajra-Holder, becomes likewise equal to the Great Vajra-Holder.

By these one hundred and eight names with which we have paid explicit praise, the great method of realizing the Great Vehicle is elaborated in full. We make this request to you, the Protector: please be so gracious as to speak the supreme rite, the great maṇḍala of the wheel of all the buddhas, its supreme greatness.

Then the Blessed One, the Great Vajra-Holder, having graciously attended to the words of the request made by all the Tathāgatas, entered into the meditative absorption called Source of the Sacred Commitment of All the Tathāgatas, Vajra, and declared this supreme great maṇḍala called Vajra Expanse: "All of these are taught in other tantras; therefore the extensive rite, in brief summary, is as follows."

Then the Blessed One, the Great Vairocana — lord of all the Tathāgatas, the Great Vajra-Bearer, father of all the Tathāgatas, mother of all the Tathāgatas — having placed those Tathāgatas and those bodhisattvas within his very heart, and having made them indivisibly one, then set them before Vajrapāṇi through the joining of expansion and contraction, and abided in the mode of the heroic meditative absorption of all the Tathāgatas.

Then the Blessed One, the Great King of Vajra-Holders, the great bodhisattva, the Teacher of all the Tathāgatas who causes the rain of Dharma of all the Tathāgatas to fall, made request to the Blessed One, the Great Vairocana — lord of all the Tathāgatas, without beginning or end: "Blessed One, please be gracious and speak the means of accomplishing buddhahood. I shall bestow buddhahood upon all sentient beings. Is this to be done according to some other method, or according to the method of the Great Vehicle?"

Then the Blessed One, the Great Vairocana, lord of all the Tathāgatas, declared these words to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, accomplish buddhahood according to the method of the Great Vehicle."

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi made this request to the Blessed One: "Is buddhahood to be accomplished by means of the maṇḍala method, or by the secret method?"

Then the Blessed One, the Great Vairocana, lord of all the Tathāgatas, declared these words to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, buddhahood is to be accomplished by the secret method. Vajrapāṇi, I myself, having received empowerment by that secret method, became fully and perfectly awakened as a buddha by that very secret method."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi made this request to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, by which master were you empowered?"

Then the Blessed One, the Great Vairocana, declared these words to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, the master called 'Secret' conferred the empowerment. Having received that secret, buddhahood was attained."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi made this request to the Blessed One: "What is the intrinsic nature of that secret? What Dharma did he teach? Did he teach some other method of practice, or did he reveal to you the way of the profound?"

The Blessed One said: "Not knowing the intrinsic nature of that secret — what could one say of it?"

Then the Great Vairocana, lord of all the Tathāgatas, declared these words to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, he taught no Dharma and explained not even the slightest thing. Rather, Vajrapāṇi, by the method of his own wisdom and through the distinction of that wisdom, one must oneself begin the practice of the secret.

"Then, from the support of the secret, those drops of milk endowed with rays of light will arise. From the garland of rays of light, the bodies of all the Tathāgatas are to be drawn forth. From those Tathāgata bodies, the forms of the vajra suffused with garlands of rays of light, and the forms of the wrathful ones, are to be drawn out."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi made this request to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, even so — by what mode of appearance is the practice of that very secret accomplished?"

Then the Blessed One, the Great Vairocana, lord of all the Tathāgatas, declared these words to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, I shall first explain to you what is to be done — listen well. The mantra practitioner must first have my meditative absorption go before, then generate the self-deity, and accomplish all the great goddess-consorts of the lineages of all the Tathāgatas and all the queens of vidyā. Thereafter one must practice the secret itself."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi made this request to the Blessed One, who is without beginning or end: "By what mode of appearance shall I accomplish those goddesses?"

The Blessed One declared: "Among sentient beings, there are some who possess faith and who wish to accomplish the self-deity with one-pointed mind, yet who do not know the method of practice and lack the capacity. Even though their lives may run out, the compassionate mind of the goddesses will not arise for them, nor will clarity of mind be produced. Therefore, Vajrapāṇi, the bodhisattva, the great being, must know the method of practice. For that very reason, Vajrapāṇi, through complete proficiency in all mudrās and

mantras, accomplishment will occur in as many days as are fixed by the sun. Therefore, Vajrapāṇi, this tantra accomplishes through complete proficiency in the practice of all the gods and goddesses and the queens of vidyā."

Therefore, Vajrapāṇi is declared to be the master of mantras and the lord of secrets.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, since I am not a mantra-master and am not yet the lord of secrets, I beseech the Blessed One to act in such a way that I may become the lord of secrets and mantras."

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, the mantra-master should for the time being accomplish other siddhis. Once those are accomplished, all activities may be performed — driving away, killing, bringing under control, paralyzing, summoning, and the like. And if even the siddhi of buddhahood itself and so forth can be accomplished, what need is there even to speak of other siddhis?"

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what should I accomplish first? Should I accomplish the queen of vidyā? Or should I accomplish subjugation and the like? Or should I accomplish the sword and so forth? Blessed One, I beseech you to declare to me which siddhi I should accomplish first."

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, lord of all Tathāgatas, granted his approval to the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, saying "Excellent!" — "Vajrapāṇi, excellent, excellent! Therefore, Vajrapāṇi, first accomplish the queen of vidyā, by means of which secrets will be bestowed upon sentient beings."

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, I beseech you to declare in what manner I should accomplish that goddess."

Then the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, you should be patient with the practice of what will be explained in another section."

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, with which other section should I be patient?"

Then the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi in these words: "Vajrapāṇi, there exist sentient beings who are like the fruit of the kimśuka tree — outwardly their form is magnificent, yet inwardly their essential quality has decayed and dissipated, and they are capable of dissolution and death and the like. To

sentient beings of that kind, who are roused merely by the outward explanation of secrets but upon inner examination are found to lack faith, and who are thoroughly committed to the vehicles of the śrāvakas — to these this tantra should not be explained. Vajrapāṇi, therefore, accomplish those goddesses by means of the union of pleasing each of them with her own mudrā and mantras."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, by what manner shall I know the secret mantras of pleasing?"

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, lord of all Tathāgatas, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, this is not a matter of secret mantras of pleasing. Vajrapāṇi, accomplish them by means of the power of union. Vajrapāṇi, listen! The manner by which the gods together with the goddesses of vidyā are accomplished, and by which, once accomplished, buddhahood itself is bestowed — that I shall explain to you in due order."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, I beseech you to declare by what manner those goddesses bestow buddhahood."

Then the Blessed One, lord of all Tathāgatas, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, I shall explain the manner by which those goddesses are accomplished, and the secret reality by which those goddesses are fully accomplished. Listen!

Whichever goddess a mantra-holder deems fitting to accomplish, he should accomplish her. By means of the union of his own mudrā and mantra, he should summon that goddess and place her before him. Then he himself should meditate on the form of the bodhisattva Vajrasattva according to the stages explained previously, and with that form of Vajrasattva he should give pleasure to the goddess. Once pleased, she will without doubt bestow the attainment."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, by what manner does she become pleased?"

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, with that very form of Vajrasattva, one should engage the goddess through the vajra in her secret lotus. Through that engagement she becomes bliss itself, and then that goddess, filled with joy, will bestow the supreme

attainment.

Just as a woman looks with delight upon her own lord, so too will that goddess look with delight upon the holder of the secret mantra, by the power of that joy. By the power of joy she becomes satisfied. If even a common woman, when engaged, bestows the supreme — what need is there to speak of a goddess? Vajrapāṇi, consider the example: just as a woman who has been pierced by a gross vajra does not desire another lord, so too that goddess, once she has been pierced by the secret, does not desire another mantra-holder.

In this way, through the secret union, whichever goddess is accomplished through the peaceful mode becomes accomplished in the peaceful form. Whichever is accomplished through the wrathful mode becomes accomplished in the wrathful form. Moreover, taking on the form of the wrathful deity Vajra-Hūṃkāra, the mantra-holder should accomplish goddesses such as Vajragāndhārī and so forth. Taking on the form of Īśvara, the lord of the world, he should accomplish Tārā and so forth."

Then Vajrapāṇi asked the Blessed One: "Blessed One, how then is the wrathful mode to be established?"

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "By means of that very practice of Vajra-Hūṃkāra, one should accomplish the Blessed Lady called Vajragāndhārī, the goddess of vidyā."

Then, having declared these words, the great Vairocana became merged as one, and through the meditative absorption that conquers the three realms, he emanated Vajra-Hūṃkāra together with Vajragāndhārī, definitively and for the sake of taming all fierce sentient beings.

Then that very goddess Vajra-Hūṃkāra gazed with eyes of supreme delight and spoke this solemn declaration:

How wondrous! Among all the wrathful,
the vajra-wrathful is supreme, unsurpassed.
Having obtained this beautiful one,
may all the fierce be tamed.

Then Vajrapāṇi said to Vajra-Hūṃkāra: "Excellent, Vajra-Hūṃkāra! Having obtained this goddess, become a buddha!"

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, by what manner is this goddess to be accomplished?"

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, lord of all Tathāgatas, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, listen! I shall explain the method of accomplishing all the goddesses by which, through pleasing them, those accomplishments are attained."

Then the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, listen! This Vajra-Gandhārī is to be accomplished in the wrathful manner. The mantra-practitioner, Vajrapāṇi, should abide in the form of Vajra-Hūṃkāra, bind the mudrā of the Conqueror of the Three Realms, consecrate his own body, and once again sit in the cross-legged posture. Then he should recite the mantra of the Conqueror of the Three Realms:

Oṃ sumbha nisumbha hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Gṛhṇa gṛhṇa hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Gṛhṇāpaya gṛhṇāpaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ ānaya hoḥ bhagavan vidyārāja hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.

This is to be recited three times, and then the accomplishment is to be performed.

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words: "By what heart-essence will this goddess be accomplished?"

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, entered into meditative absorption in the samādhi called the Great Vajra Wrathful One. Thereupon he declared the vidyā of the samādhi that tears asunder the three realms: "By this, all possessing spirits and similar spirits — even those such as Śakra (Indra), who subdue others through causing fear and inflicting suffering — will be put to flight. By mere recitation of this, all people will be made joyful. In the wrathful manner, it destroys all that is malevolent. It drives away everything. It causes everything to be dispersed.

Therefore, Vajrapāṇi, the mantra-practitioner should recite and read this in the following manner:

Namaḥ Śaṇḍavajrapāṇaye mahāyakṣasenāpataye. Namo bhagavate Vajragandhari. Anekaraśmiśatasahasraprajvalitadīpta. Jayai ugra bhīṣmabhayānikāyai. Yoginyai. Bhīṣmabhaginyai. Khaḍgamukhāye. Dvādaśanetrāyai. Dvādaśabhujāyai. Vikīṛṇakeśāyai. Anekārūpividhiviśvadhāriṇyai. Ehy ehi bhagavati mahāvajragandhari trayāṇām ratnānām. Satyena ākarṣaya. Akaddhya. Baladevam. Maheśvaram. Brāhmaṇam. Indram. Candram. Yamam. Varuṇam. Vāyum. Kuberam. Dhṛtarāṣṭram. Virūḍhakam. Virūpākṣam. Śaṃkukarṇam. Korṇam.

Sthūlakantha. Mahākālam. Nandikeśvaram. Bhīgiriti. Nāyakam. Vināyakam. Pāñcikam. Dāmakam. Lohakam. Śiṣṭi. Devīkoṭi. Girikoṭa. Oṃkāri. Durgām. Kātyāyanī. Caṇḍakātyāyanī. Eṣaṇī. Nairṛtyām. Kālim. Mahākālī. Bhadrakālim. Vajrakālim. Cūrṇakālim. Kṣudrakālim. Śaktim. Śālikavartti. Śatākṣīm. Indrāṇī. Brāhmaṇī. Kaumārī. Maheśvarīm. Subhagam. Raudrī. Cāmuṇḍam. Vārāhī. Kauberī. Ye ca anye samayena natiṣṭhanti tān āvartayiṣyāmi śīghraṃ grhṇa. Oṃ la la la la. Hu lu hu lu. Cu lu cu lu. Mu lu mu lu. Dhama dhama. Raṃga raṃga. Raṃgāpaya raṃgapaya. Pura pura. Pūraya pūraya. Ānaya ānaya. Āviśa āviśa. Āveśaya āveśaya. Bhagavati mahāvajragandhari siddhyaṇcaṇḍavajrapāṇirājñāpayati hrīḥ. Haḥ. Haḥ. Haḥ. Haḥ. Hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

Vajrapāṇi, by the mere recitation of this, even mountains and the like that cannot be drawn in will be drawn in.

Then the Blessed One declared the ritual method of accomplishment: "Beginning from the first day of the bright fortnight until the eighth day, eight thousand recitations are to be performed. After that, the accomplishment will be attained. Once attained, all actions may be performed. Summoning is done pleasurably with an incense of guggul. All of these have been explained on the outer path.

For those who have properly mounted the great elephant of the Great Vehicle, what satisfaction is there in that?"

With the mantra and mudrā of Vajra Gandharī, one draws in and binds the conqueror of the three realms. The middle fingers are interlaced with each other, and the little fingers are turned to point downward. This mudrā, formed in the shape of a jewel, is the pledged gift of the Blessed One.

Then, for the formation of the root mudrā:

The vajra palms are firmly joined.

Open them apart above.

Bring the middle fingers to their tips.

Set the nameless ones face-to-face neatly.

The two thumbs, having been joined,
are to be placed upon the tips.

This is the Blessed One's root seal.

That same is the mudrā of the throne of the thumbs crossed in meditation posture.

That same, applied through the practice of full release, is the mudrā of

sending forth.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, by what manner of approach does one bring sentient beings under one's power?"

Then the Blessed One Vairocana declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, meditate on the Blessed One Lady through the mantra of the samādhi of Vajra Hūṃ. Seat her upon both thighs, embrace her tightly, then seize her root face's lips with one's teeth. Place the vajra into her bhaga. After that, the goddess will speak thus: 'Ah ho, how delightful!' Through union of that kind, the goddess is accomplished, and thereafter all actions are performed.

If burnt offerings are made with sandalwood fuel anointed with butter, Brahmā and all the other gods will come under one's power, and having come under it, they will say: 'Command us — what shall we do?' All of that is accomplished with a single night.

Then, for one who desires to bring human beings under one's power: through that same goddess, one consecrates a little white mustard seed in samādhi and blows it onto a brahmin, and he will come under one's power. For the warrior class, the rite is the same. Through that same samādhi, one praises āmalaka fruit, and if it is given to a merchant, he will come under one's power. Through that same samādhi, one consecrates black pepper and gives it to a commoner, and he will come under one's power. By following these in sequence and giving accordingly to women suited to each class, they too will come under one's power.

Through that same samādhi, one consecrates cremation-ground ash, and in whatever home it is placed, the inhabitants will die. Through that same samādhi, if one gazes upon someone with a fierce look, that person will die. If one gazes upon someone with a wrathful look, that person will be set in motion. Even all the gods and bodhisattvas such as Vajrapāṇi, and even one such as I, will be set in motion."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, if this great king of union practices even moves buddhas, what need is there to speak of moving others?"

Then the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, whatever is accomplished even to a small degree through this method of the Great Vehicle will without fail come to fulfilment."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, for what reason is it said that accomplishment comes through eight thousand recitations in the sequence of recitation?"

The great Blessed One Vairocana declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, the count of recitations and the count of days that has been explained pertains to those of the śrāvaka vehicle. Those who follow along with faith in the śrāvaka vehicle will not attain buddhahood even across many lives. Yet if they do achieve accomplishment, they will in this very life obtain the enjoyments of royalty and the like."

Those who have truly mounted the vehicle of the Great Vehicle will attain buddhahood itself in as little as a single day — so what need is there to speak of other accomplishments over many days? Vajrapāṇi, just as a vehicle equipped with an elephant or a supreme horse reaches the desired destination without ever faltering along the way, so too one who travels by the Great Vehicle, guided by correct instruction and fully equipped, goes wherever they wish without pause. Know then that such a one has arrived at Vairocana himself, or Vajrapāṇi, or has reached another state entirely. Therefore, Vajrapāṇi, one who abides in the manner of the Great Vehicle will come to be entirely free of conceptual thought. Thus one should fully embrace the non-conceptuality of all phenomena.

For this reason, Vajrapāṇi, the bodhisattva, the great being, should meditate with the meditation: "I myself am lord of all the goddesses." Vajrapāṇi, in the same way, the distinctive quality of meditating on the vajra of all the goddesses — by which all activities are accomplished and buddhahood is achieved — shall now be explained again.

Vajrapāṇi, listen. When one performs even a small amount of the mantra of the wrathful one, one should visualize entering the bhaga of the Blessed Lady Vajragandharī by this method, uniting the eight channels into one by means of the subtle application, and imagining a flow of fluid from that single channel. If the practitioner wishes to bring someone under subjugation, one visualizes the color as red. From that red fluid, one visualizes oneself in the form of Vajrahūṃkāra. In the form of Vajrahūṃkāra, one brings all sentient beings under subjugation. One will travel unobstructed.

If one wishes to kill, then one visualizes those channels as black in color, like glowing embers. From their red fluid, the practitioner cultivates the form of Vajrahūṃkāra, and by means of that form of Vajrahūṃkāra, one emanates

from it a vajra, from that a three-pronged weapon, from that a sword, from that a noose, from that a hook, from that an arrow, from that a spear — and with these one slays whomever one wishes to kill. The same applies to expelling as well.

If one wishes to attain buddhahood itself, one visualizes those channels as white in color, and from their fluid, which resembles milk, one cultivates the form of Vajrahūṃkāra, and through that one accomplishes buddhahood itself, or Vairocana himself, or Vajrapāṇi himself.

Alternatively, the Blessed One Vairocana is himself a buddha, and Vajrasattva is himself a buddha. Therefore, Vajrapāṇi, by recitation of that single one, all activities are accomplished. By this very sequence one can shatter mountains and split apart any terrain, no matter how vast. By this same sequence, through generating the divine body, one accomplishes all activities. Moreover, if one generates oneself as the body of the secret deity, that master will attain buddhahood — and for this reason one is called a master.

When that master gives instruction in the manner of the śrāvaka tradition and so forth, at that time he is not truly a master — know him rather as an enemy. But when he bestows the secret teachings, know him accordingly as the Blessed One Vajrasattva himself. Even if he speaks only a single word, one should stand before him, bow at his feet with palms joined, and listen reverently. From the moment of having listened, that disciple must not enter into, nor remain among, those who belong to the śrāvaka vehicle — because one who follows with faith would thereby come to disparage the Great Vehicle.

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"I shall not dwell within the śrāvaka vehicle. And if I do dwell there, it shall be in the manner of the Great Vehicle — not in outward appearance alone."

Then once again Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, even toward one who merely speaks of the Great Vehicle, I bow down, I show reverence, I take them as my master, and I offer worship. Blessed One, therefore this one is a speaker of Dharma, while all others are not speakers of Dharma — they speak falsely."

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, lord of all Tathāgatas, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, therefore, whatever great being hears and upholds this tantra — know him to be like me or like you. He dwells within my heart, and one who listens to him should understand it to be just so. Therefore I too bow

down to him before you, Vajrapāṇi. Thus, this is a speaker of Dharma; all others are not speakers of Dharma. Vajrapāṇi, therefore, even one who lacks the supremely distinguished manner of teaching of a master of the Great Vehicle, or who merely lacks supremely distinguished expression — if anyone were to conceive of opposing him in their mind, that person would become utterly maddened."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, I too, with this vajra blazing on all sides and becoming a single tongue of flame, shall burn that one together with his lineage, and shall burn away all his accomplishments."

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, lord of all Tathāgatas, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, one should bind the mudrā of the goddess Tārā, invoke her, and place her before oneself. Then the mantrin should enter into union with her, unifying the body and the subtle channels, contemplate her as having the color of milk, and from that generate the form of the Lord of the World (Lokeśvara). Moreover, one should rely on the goddess Tārā through this practice of union together with the meditative absorption of the Lord of the World. Then the goddess, being pleased, will bestow the supreme. Then that goddess will come in a dream, embrace one, and one will see her adorned with all ornaments, delightful, laughing and playing, and gazing openly — and then she will say: 'Take hold of this bliss and thereby become a buddha.' Then it should be known that accomplishment will come within six months. Or if one sees another woman, know that it is that very goddess one is seeing. In that case, accomplishment will come in this very life. Furthermore, if one wishes to know secrets, one should take on the form of the Lord of the World through the meditative absorption of the Lord of the World, extend both hands, and while meditating on the right hand as a lunar disk arisen from the syllable HAM, and the left hand as a lunar disk raised up before oneself arisen from the syllable A, with the form of the noble Avalokiteśvara above it, contemplate oneself as the mantrin being illuminated by his rays of light. Then if the two hands open upward, know it to be auspicious. If they remain below, know it to be neither virtuous nor non-virtuous. If they turn to face backward, know it to be inauspicious. Furthermore, Blessed One, if one wishes to accomplish the goddess of exhortation without the practice just described, one should meditate on oneself in the form of Vajrapāṇi at the center of her secret lotus, and from the white union of her channels and the flowing practice, generate oneself as the form of Vajrasattva, and then rely upon the mudrā and mantra

of the practice of relying upon that goddess. Then through the distinction of colors one performs activities: for the expanding activity, the color is yellow —"

for pacifying, the color is white; for magnetizing, the color is red; for forceful activity, the color is black. Meditating in this way, one performs the activities in sequence. Among all these methods, if the goddess appears in a dream embracing one in the form of whatever woman one desires, know that accomplishment will come within a single day. Alternatively, if the goddess manifests in the form of another woman, know from that point that accomplishment will come in this very lifetime.

Next, if one wishes to accomplish the wrathful goddess Amoghapāśa, one should meditate upon oneself as Amoghapāśa in the meditative absorption of Amoghapāśa at the face of the channel at the center of her secret lotus, and then, in the manner of Amoghapāśa, rely upon that goddess through the union of lotus and vajra until she reaches the bliss of the crown. Then, pleased, she will bestow the supreme gift. Through the very reality of the sequence of vajra and lotus, one should accomplish whatever one desires.

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One in these words: What is the union of vajra and lotus? The Blessed One declared: What is called "vajra" is said to pierce, for just as a vajra pierces, so too does a petition pierce. The union of the lotus — the wisdom of the lotus is the wisdom of suchness. Just as when a lotus opens it brings joy to all people, so too is it with the lotus of the secret place. Moreover, just as a lotus is born from the mud yet is unstained by that mud, so too that which is born from the secret place is likewise unstained by the faults of sin — it is for this reason that it is called the lotus.

Furthermore, through the union of vajra and lotus, one becomes a buddha beyond the counting of incalculable hundreds of thousands of tens of millions of buddhas. It is for this reason that this master is said to be a buddha in truth.

Now, if a mantra practitioner is unable to meditate upon himself at the center of the secret lotus, he may instead contemplate those channels with their flowing essence in the forms of red, white, yellow, and blue, and in that way he will properly obtain the accomplishments of all activities as befits each.

If even that is not possible, one should visualize those women as the form of one's own goddess, using the reasoning of one's own method alone, and drink and cause her to drink the flowing essence of those women — and thereby buddhahood will certainly be accomplished.

Vajrapāṇi, for this reason, without the secret union there is no buddhahood through other means. Vajrapāṇi, for this reason, through the samādhi that is one's own, and through the union of precisely this method, all the goddess vidyās (knowledge goddesses) are to be accomplished — one should have no doubt about this.

Furthermore, Vajrapāṇi, if one has not found a consort of one's own, one may take exclusively another's and drink the flowing essence and so forth — and then accomplishment will come. Alternatively, one should rely in this way upon a courtesan of the locality. If even that is not found, one should then contemplate the goddess vidyā of one's own heart and rely upon her. If, while contemplating her, the flowing essence of that mantra practitioner comes forth, know from that point that accomplishment is obtained. If the flow should stabilize and hold firm, that person too should know that accomplishment is at hand.

This teaching is not to be explained to those of outward conduct, for it will lead to great transgression. The extended ritual procedure of the tantra of the goddesses from the great royal tantra of the supreme secret treasury, the Deliberating King, is hereby completely fulfilled.

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, lord of all Tathāgatas, father of all Tathāgatas, relied upon by all Tathāgatas, fulfiller of all hopes, he who enacts benefit for all sentient beings —

He who is the agent of all Tathāgatas drew all the Tathāgatas dwelling in the ten directions into his own heart, and having gathered them into one, he declared the maṇḍala called Victorious over the Three Worlds. That maṇḍala is foursquare, with four gates, adorned with eight pillars, beautified by nets and half-nets, ornamented with moons and half-moons, thronged with silk pennants and garlands of flowers, furnished with four maṇḍalas at the four gates, splendid with colored powder-dust of gold and the like. On the outer face, at the four gates, a maṇḍala decorated in that very manner is to be drawn. At its center, Akṣobhya and the rest are to be established. In the four maṇḍalas, the Tathāgatas are to be properly stationed, and at the four gates their gate-guardians are to be well placed. The vidyā goddesses are to be fully stationed in the corner niches of the maṇḍala. In the outer maṇḍala sixteen bodhisattvas are to be placed, and at the borders of the outer maṇḍala Vajrapuṣpā and the rest are to be stationed.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, resting upon a moon-disc maṇḍala in the presence of the Blessed One, addressed the Blessed One with this question: Blessed One, you are known as Victorious over the Three Worlds — why is it called the Three Worlds?

Then the Blessed One, lord of all Tathāgatas, declared to Vajrapāṇi as follows: Vajrapāṇi, the Three Worlds refers to those who dwell in the heavens above, in the human realm, and beneath the earth. Among them are certain fierce sentient beings who do not go for refuge to the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. It is for the purpose of taming and overcoming them that this maṇḍala is not a mere name alone.

Thereupon Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One: Blessed One, by what means will they be tamed?

Then the great Blessed One Vairocana drew all those Tathāgatas, the gate-guardians, the goddesses, and all those dwelling within the outer maṇḍala into his own heart, and having made them one, he took his seat upon a moon-disc maṇḍala. Adorned with the crowns of the five buddhas and with every ornament, he is proclaimed to dwell upon the moon-disc maṇḍala for the sake of experiencing every happiness and mental ease, and for the sake of purifying every affliction — that moon-disc maṇḍala being utterly stainless, pervading all regions and quarters of the earth.

Then once again the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One: Blessed One, by whom was this moon-disc maṇḍala emanated?

Then the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi: Vajrapāṇi, listen. It was made by no one and emanated by no one. Vajrapāṇi, first one should realize this through one's own mind — it is the meaning of meditation in the manner of emptiness. Then from the syllable A one should conceive a moon-disc maṇḍala equal to the sky. Just as the sky abides in the manner of permanence, so too is this moon-disc maṇḍala. Within it, the vowel letters beginning with A are established in the manner of non-arising. Furthermore, the consonant letters beginning with Ka are established in the manner of nectar. All of these in their totality are to be regarded in the manner of the sky.

Then the mind will come to know each thing distinctly. Then again the Blessed One declared the second awakening moon to Vajrapāṇi: Vajrapāṇi, the second awakening moon is utterly stainless and strips away all conceptual thought. Because it strips away every last trace of conceptual thought, it is called the one that strips away all conceptual thought — this is its supreme and

unsurpassable meaning. Vajrapāṇi, for that reason it is declared the awakening moon. Through attaining it, all sentient beings become perfectly and completely awakened buddhas at the unsurpassable level. That very moon, together with the syllable Ka and the rest, is endowed with the qualities of a buddha.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, what is the intrinsic nature of those syllables? In what manner are they endowed with the qualities of a buddha?

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, declared to Vajrapāṇi: Vajrapāṇi, listen. Hear from what source these syllables beginning with Ka have arisen, what their intrinsic nature is, and by whom they were emanated. They have come from a world-realm called the Resounding of Ka, which is the seeing of the qualities of a buddha. All of those are the intrinsic nature of Vairocana, the body of the Tathāgata — this is the meaning of the body equal to the sky. Having the nature of indivisibility and the nature of clarity, it becomes a canopy through the form of the moon-disc maṇḍala, pervading all directions and regions, arresting birth, aging, death, suffering, mental discomfort, anguish, and the like, dripping with the nature of nectar, stripping away the conceptual thought of the three worlds. Resting therein — this, together with the syllable Ṭha, carries the meaning of the many combinations that signify the nature of Tāṭa-Maṭa as being the one endowed with non-dispersion. Together with the syllable Ṭa it bears the gathering of mountains, and together with the syllable Ṇa it enters into that through forms such as the exceedingly gentle stars and so forth. Just as a star is stainless and endowed with light, so too this is called the stainless quality of a buddha. It has the nature of holding, endowed with generosity and moral discipline — just as the earth-holding mountains hold all things, so too does this hold all sentient beings. In order to destroy the evil companionship of those sentient beings who are spiritually bereft, the mothers — the Prajñās — praised the lord of all Tathāgatas, the Blessed One, with this invocation of the secret:

Excellent! O supreme glorious vajra,
great father of all buddhas,
supreme one joined in excellent yoga —
to the excellent supreme one, praise and homage!

Homage to the supreme seal of excellent mantra,
the supreme of the supreme, the very pinnacle of primordial wisdom,

the supreme of the renowned great deeds of excellent action —
to the supreme vajra, praise and homage!

Homage to the supreme excellent jewel, the supreme Dharma,
the essential vidyā-mantra, the supreme sacred commitment,
the supreme that illuminates vajra wisdom —
to the supreme maṇḍala, most excellent, praise and homage!

Perfectly pure primordial wisdom, the supreme of all,
set in equipoise in supreme emptiness,
the supreme of excellent diligence, the supreme bodhisattva —
to the supreme wisdom, praise and homage!

The essence of the mothers of primordial wisdom
was spoken by the Blessed One:
seal, mantra, and vidyā,
vow, and the great sacred commitment.

Then the Blessed One declared the maṇḍala of vowels belonging to the
Dharma-mothers of profundity — the maṇḍala of the great yoga, the secret
ornament:

The essence — seal, mantra, and vidyās —
abide merely as conventional designations.
The mantras arising from that
I shall examine according to their distinctions.

Essence, seal, mantra, and vidyās
are not seen otherwise as conventional.
Even vidyā, in the aspect of feeling —

in its defining characteristic, wisdom is explained;
by the illuminating cause, it is made perfectly clear;
the essence is explained as merely conventional.

What is to be known by all the mothers —
in accordance with the proper sequence,
it is established as the wheel of the maṇḍala.

The four vowel-seed syllables of wisdom
are the seeds of the mothers upon the spokes.

The seed of the fathers is on the petals;
the remainder is to be understood as external.

Such is the analysis as it has been taught.

Then, through the self-same act of invocation,
the dharmadhātu is to be proclaimed.

Draw it as the maṇḍala before,
and the master, with proper ceremonial knowledge,
shall at that time enter in appropriate attire
and introduce the disciple into the sacred maṇḍala.
Having declared the pure nature of Dharma —
that this migration is merely conventional —
recalling the suchness of Dharma,
let the handful of flowers be cast.

Then oneself shall receive empowerment,
and that self too is merely conventional.

The sovereign lord of all phenomena and dharmas,
the sacred lord of mastery shall be attained.

All secret mantras of the world and beyond the world
shall be accomplished.

By the mere act of entering into mantra practice,
what need is there to speak of the empowerment itself?
By the practice connected with this very teaching,
let the disciple's sacred entry be made.

Having taught the suchness of Dharma,
the face is to be veiled with a cloth of white,
and in the same way the flowers are to be cast.

"By the dharmadhātu I receive you."

Let them be made to hear this sacred commitment.

The disciple who knows the sacred commitment —
to anyone other than such a one,
you must not reveal the Mother.

If through confusion it is proclaimed and elaborated —

through the practice of benefiting the noble ones and so forth, through
practice of benefiting others, and through the ways of the Great Vehicle, it
fulfills all the hopes of all sentient beings. Endowed with all secret offerings, it
bestows unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. It has the nature of
bringing under its power all sentient beings — men, women, and the like — by
arising together with the graceful taste of the amorous demeanor of

attachment that pervades all sentient beings. Endowed with the sound of a conch, it accomplishes all aims and leads all sounds of the three worlds, enacting benefit for all sentient beings. Possessed of compassion expressed in the resounding laughter of the syllable Hā Hā, through the practice of the syllables of the stream of nectar it bestows upon women and men alike the supreme bliss.

Here, Vajrapāṇi, all the great bodhisattvas, the mahāsattvas, those fully endowed with the Great Vehicle, should meditate upon all of these.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, resting upon a lunar disc before the Blessed One, spoke thus to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, by what means will those sentient beings who are endowed with a malevolent mind be tamed?"

Thereupon the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, entered into meditative absorption into the samādhi called "Blessing the Arising of the Sacred Commitment of Vajrasattva," and manifested the arising of the form of Vajrasattva — white, endowed with pride, adorned with all ornaments, blazing with rays of light, brandishing the vajra, fulfilling all hopes — and decisively drew forth the one who bestows the very certainty of being Vajrasattva. With that body of Vajrasattva, he hooked all the gods dwelling on Mount Meru with the vajra-hook, bound them with the vajra-lasso, felled them with the vajra-strike, and satisfied them with the vajra-bell. He accomplished it. Jaḥ Hūṃ Baṃ Hoḥ.

"Vajrapāṇi, from without, through the power of the gods, the malevolent sentient beings are to be subdued."

Thereupon those sentient beings, truly mounting the chariot of the way of the Great Vehicle, together with the maṇḍala and —

endowed with the engagement of sacred commitments, and by the mere sight of the great maṇḍala they come to know all sacred commitments.

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, by what means shall we cause these malevolent sentient beings to enter?"

Thereupon the great Vairocana, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Listen, Vajrapāṇi. By that very method of Vajrahūṃkāra, hook those sentient beings and bring them in."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, by that very method, took on the form of Vajrahūṃkāra. And Vajrahūṃkāra — utterly fierce and wrathful, great lord of the yakṣas, gnashing lips and fangs, four-faced, his body that of the Great

Wrathful One blazing with the appearance of light that illumines all three worlds, emanating numerous forms of Vajrahūṃkāra from the many garlands of vajra-rays, endowed with great radiance, bearing the weapons of the great blazing vajra — arose in that form. And assuming that very body, he requested permission from the Blessed One Vairocana to take his place upon the lunar maṇḍala in his presence, saying: "May I be given permission for whatever I am to do."

Then the Blessed One Vairocana declared to Vajrahūṃkāra: "Hook these malevolent sentient beings and bring them in."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrahūṃkāra, having heard the command of the Blessed One, hooked in an instant the gods dwelling in the human realm, in the intermediate sky, and below the earth, together with the ḍākinīs and all the planetary spirits, and declared: "Come, friends! Enter my maṇḍala! Listen to my command!"

Then those subtle sentient beings entered, and addressed the Blessed One: "How are we to follow your command, Blessed One?"

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi declared to them: "Refrain from non-virtues such as killing living beings. Take refuge in the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha."

"Blessed One, we shall do as you have said," they replied, and departed.

Then those gods and the others spoke together with one voice, saying among themselves: "What sort of thing is this, this entering into this maṇḍala?"

Thereupon Vajrapāṇi-Vajrahūṃkāra commanded those sentient beings: "You malevolent sentient beings — do as I say! Touch my feet and enter my maṇḍala!"

Then those gods and the others, having heard his command, spoke thus: "What is your name? And why should we obey your words?"

Thereupon the great wrathful one Vajrahūṃkāra, that great bodhisattva, with the blazing vajra became wrathful together against those gods and the rest, and engaged in great conflict, so that they all fell down. Those malevolent sentient beings, having been struck senseless, once again joined their palms together and addressed that great bodhisattva: "As the Blessed One has commanded, so shall we do."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi caused those gods and the others to enter the maṇḍala and showed it to them. Upon seeing the maṇḍala, they touched the two feet of the great Vairocana, and standing at a respectful distance, thought to themselves: "The Blessed One is such that even a servant of one so exalted as this is endowed with such power."

"How wonderful! Even by the mere words of a servant of this great sovereign of Dharma, all these gods and the others were struck senseless" — thus they thought to themselves.

Then Vajrapāṇi bestowed upon all of them the three refuges, the vows, and the trainings. He then sprinkled them with vajra water, placed the vajra upon the crown of their heads, and declared: "O gods, do not transgress this Dharma!"

Thereupon those gods and the others addressed Vajrapāṇi thus: "Vajrapāṇi, whoever should revile the Great Vehicle — their life I shall take. And those who abide in the Great Vehicle: in their dwelling place I shall remain for a long time, protecting them fully from the four directions and the ten quarters, and rendering all manner of service."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, supported by a moon-disc maṇḍala in the presence of the Blessed One, addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, who is this great bodhisattva-like figure who appears blue as the sky when seen against the open sky, who holds a trident in his hand, whose coiled topknot of matted hair spreads to fill the entirety of space, who is surrounded by many attendants, who holds a crescent moon, whose nature is to smile slightly, and who abides with pride and arrogance?"

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, this is the pride of one called the Great God (Śiva): 'I am the lord of all three worlds. I it is who summons whomever else there may be.' He abides in such a great display of magical illusion born of pride."

Vajrapāṇi replied: "Blessed One, what is this wickedness? Does he truly abide as lord of the three worlds?"

"Vajrapāṇi, it is so."

Then the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, with a wrathful countenance, assumed the form of Vajrapāṇi as a blazing vajra-body whose radiance equaled that of twelve thousand million suns, who roared with the sound of a great ocean, who pervaded the entirety of space like the wind at the time of dissolution

stirring all — a form of the great wrathful one. Standing in the presence of the Blessed One, he declared: "Blessed One, this malevolent sentient being who abides as lord of the three worlds — with this blazing vajra I shall burn every body of him and his retinue entirely."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, having assumed such a form, stood before the lord of the three worlds. Thereupon the lord of the three worlds began to engage in great battle with his own retinue. Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi pierced that one together with his retinue with a vajra blazing on all sides, become as a single tongue of flame. Then the lord of the three worlds, seeing all of them being slain, trembled at heart and, together with his consort, enclosed himself within a threefold iron fence and remained there.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, with that vajra and all those weapons, utterly burned through the threefold iron fence. He then pierced the lord of the three worlds — the Great God — together with his consort, with that iron hook and vajra, drew him forth, and cast him down at the two feet of the Blessed One.

Thereupon the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One thus: "This malevolent sentient being has been brought before you — what shall I now do with him?"

Even as he said this, at that very moment the Great God rose up together with his consort and attempted to flee. As they went, there in space, to a height of equal measure, excrement and

urine, deeply foul-smelling with many stinking odors, surrounded them with a fence of impurity, and there they remained.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, the Hūṃkāra, looked about, but could not see that malevolent sentient being. Gazing into the space between, he beheld the Great God and his consort enclosed just so — remaining there surrounded by a fence of impurity. Then, with that vajra blazing and ablaze on all sides, he shattered that fence, dragged the Great God together with his consort back, flung them down, and pressing his left foot upon the Great God's head, with his right foot he pressed down upon the full, swelling breasts of the goddess Umā. He then declared: "Ha! Malevolent sentient being — what is to be done with you?"

Upon seeing the lord of the three worlds reduced to such a condition, the assembled gods were filled with wonder and with fear, and this thought arose in their minds: "How remarkable — the lord of the three worlds has come to this state. Good enough for us, it seems, that we are not in that position."

Then the Great God, seeing those gods, summoned his courage and began raising a great terrifying outcry — the fearsome war-cry that terrifies the three worlds — proclaiming it aloud throughout the three worlds, attempting to inspire dread. But the great bodhisattva pressed down upon the Great God with his left foot ever more forcefully, and even so, the Great God's voice was utterly silenced.

Then the great bodhisattva, the great being, remaining in one aspect in the form of the Hūṃkāra and going in another aspect in the form of Vajrapāṇi before the Blessed One, addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, what am I to do about the great cry this malevolent sentient being is raising?"

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, entered into the meditative absorption called the Vajra that Utterly Vanquishes All Obstacles, and from his own heart he drew forth this essence-mantra:

HŪṢ.

With this essence-mantra, he struck it down upon the crown of Vajrapāṇi's feet. Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what is the name of that essence-mantra?"

The Blessed One, the great Vairocana, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, that essence-mantra is one that cuts through the heart of all malevolent sentient beings."

Then the Hūṃkāra, upon hearing those words, with a slightly smiling countenance, and with a sound like the crashing of ocean waves driven by the gale-force wind of a great apocalyptic storm, cried HŪṢ — "Malevolent sentient being, sit still! Sit still!" — and stamped his left foot upon the crown of the Great God's head, pressing him down.

Then the goddess, placing her palms together and holding them at the crown of her head, spoke these words: "Ah, what great majesty! For this reason alone — that my lord, who is victorious over the three worlds, has been utterly pressed down by his left foot — it is the highest service to be his maidservant. I too wish to be his consort." And she thought further: "That I have endured suffering such as this — it is on account of that. My lord, the sovereign of the

three worlds, is fair in form yet lacks true power."

Then the Hūṃkāra, knowing her mind, looked upon her with a wrathful gaze and declared: "Ah! This woman is supremely beautiful and alluring."

Then the Great God once again began to stir his limbs and extremities and to gnaw at his lips.

Then the Blessed One, the Hūṃkāra, beheld him and, with wrathful intent, struck him through on all sides with that vajra weapon and slew him.

Then the goddess, weeping, spoke these words:

"How can it be that my lord, the sovereign of the three worlds, has been slain by this one? What am I to do now?" So she spoke.

Then the Hūṃkāra pressed down upon the goddess firmly with his left foot and made as if to slay her. Then the goddess, with a trembling mind, spoke these words: "Blessed One, are you going to destroy me? I am your servant."

Then the great bodhisattva Hūṃkāra looked upon her once more with a gaze of wonder and thought: "This beautiful woman should be offered to the Blessed One as a teacher's gift."

Then the goddess beseeched Vajrapāṇi: "Great bodhisattva, please protect the life of this one with your great compassion."

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, having heard the goddess's words, with a compassionate mind spoke to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, release this great being. This fortunate one shall become a buddha."

Then the great bodhisattva said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, how can this malevolent sentient being be one who is fortunate?"

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, this one is indeed fortunate, and therefore release him."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi restored the lord of the three worlds fully to life — reciting the mantra Oṃ vajrasattva hūṃ, the mantra called "Vajra" — and having revived him, declared: "This fair one, if you wish to offer her, send her forth."

Then the Great God (Śiva), rising from his many sufferings, greatly weakened, said to him: "Blessed One, command me as to what I should do. This wife of mine — let alone speaking of her — whatever you desire, take her. And beyond that, I shall offer further gifts to the teacher."

Then Vajrapāṇi released the Great God, and having released him, said to him: "Come, enter the maṇḍala of the Blessed One, the great bodhisattva, and act in accordance with his commands."

Then the great bodhisattva Hūṃkāra conferred the vows upon him: "From this day forward, do not engage in slaying living beings and the like."

Then the blindfold was removed, and the maṇḍala was revealed. When the Great God beheld the maṇḍala, he was filled with wonder and said: "Ah, this maṇḍala is supremely beautiful!"

Then the great bodhisattva, the great Lord (Mahāśvara), upon beholding the master of all the Tathāgatas, thought: "Alas, wretched that I am — how is it that I did not act in accordance with his command from the very beginning?" And he was filled with sorrow.

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, with that vajra, performed the vajra-water empowerment upon the Great God. At the very moment of conferring the empowerment, he was prophesied to become the Sovereign of Ash, the Tathāgata known as the Sovereign of Ash, in a world-realm covered in ash. Thus the empowerment was conferred through the power of this vajra name.

Then the Tathāgata Sovereign of Ash said to the Blessed One Vairocana: "Blessed One, if I may have a small portion of what is to be offered to the teacher, Blessed One, please accept it."

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, declared to the Tathāgata Sovereign of Ash: "Whatever is to be offered to the teacher — this very mode you must not transgress, and furthermore, never speak of it to others."

Then again the Great God (Śiva) said to the Blessed One: "Be that as it may, please accept whatever offering is made to the teacher." Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi said to that great bodhisattva: "Whatever is offered to the teacher, I shall receive it." Then that great bodhisattva said to Vajrapāṇi: "I shall offer my wife, and shall offer material goods and the like as well." Then Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, shall I take this wife, or shall I take the material goods and the like?" Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, what use are material goods? If this wife is offered, you must take her. Do not give rise to any conceptual thought." Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi declared to that great bodhisattva: "Great bodhisattva, give me your wife." Then the great

bodhisattva Sovereign of Ash, filled with joy and delight, offered his wife to the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi with a mind of complete satisfaction.

Then that goddess, seeing Vajrapāṇi to be exceedingly young and beautiful in appearance, was filled with joy and delight, and thought to herself: "I am truly fortunate." And she said to him: "How wonderful — the Dharma of the Blessed One, for the sake of sentient beings, has assumed such a form and taken on a fearsome appearance, for the purpose of generating my happiness and mental ease, and for the sake of receiving entry into the maṇḍala." Then the Tathāgata Sovereign of Ash thought to himself: "How astonishing — my wife does not count me at all." Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, master of all tathāgatas, conferred empowerment upon the one called the Tathāgata Sovereign of Ash, saying: "Go to that world-realm covered in ash." And the Tathāgata Sovereign of Ash departed to that world-realm and to all the tathāgatas there, by the mere force of the empowerment.

Then that goddess, seeing her own excellent physical form once more, spoke again: "Whether I become his servant supreme or not — I shall become his foremost wife. I am truly fortunate." Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi took that beautiful woman, and remaining before the Blessed One, said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please accept the teacher's offering. I offer you this beautiful woman." Then the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Keep her for yourself." Then the goddess again thought to herself: "If I am offered by this one to this master of all tathāgatas as a teacher's offering, then even if I become his servant, I am truly fortunate." Then Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please accept this beautiful woman." Then the Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, do as I have said." Then the Blessed One took her, examined her, conferred empowerment upon her with vajra water, placed her upon his two thighs, and declared to her: "You are the great goddess of the vajra lineage of all the tathāgatas." Then that goddess, hearing these words spoken nearby, remained with a mind of joy and delight.

Then the gods and planetary spirits and the rest circumambulated the Blessed One together with the great goddess in union with Vajrapāṇi in the great maṇḍala three times to the right, made prostrations from afar, took their leave with the Blessed One's permission, and departed.

Then the Blessed One declared to them: "Guard this Great Vehicle with great care and effort."

Then those gods said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, should any sentient beings arise who disparage the Great Vehicle and denigrate it, we shall utterly destroy them." The Blessed One declared: "Destroy those who denigrate the Great Vehicle as best you are able." Then those divine sons cried out "Excellent!" in chorus to the Blessed One and departed.

Then the great Vairocana, from that day forward, conferred upon that beautiful goddess empowerment by the power of the vajra name, calling her Vajranṭyā, "Vajra Dancer." He established her in the chamber of the left lunar maṇḍala, and dwelt there together with her in the union of play. Then through the grace of that buddha, that goddess became endowed with a thousand excellent and beautiful qualities. Then the Blessed One abode there in great bliss together with her in the union of embracing and kissing.

Then Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), surrounded by many hundreds of thousands of divine sons and many thousands of divine maidens, arrived together with magnificent thrones and the singing of sweet melodies, and let fall a great rain of flowers of many and varied kinds.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, who has let fall this rain of many-colored and variegated flowers? Who is it that has arrived with many hundreds of thousands of thrones?"

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, master of all tathāgatas, entered into and observed from within the meditative absorption of Samantabhadra. Having observed, he then declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, Śakra, lord of the gods, has come in accordance with the samaya commitment of all the tathāgatas."

Then Vajrapāṇi, with pride, brandished his vajra and blazed with great fury, and said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, with this vajra blazing and flaming all around, I shall crush his power." Then the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, he has not come with a mind of hostility — do not act in that way."

Then the great Vairocana entered into the very body of that outer goddess of form and remained there. Then Śakra, lord of the gods, arrived and circumambulated three times, and said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, please admit me into this great maṇḍala. I shall accomplish the very awakening that is unsurpassed, perfect, and complete." Then the Blessed One admitted Śakra, lord of the gods, into the maṇḍala, and once he had admitted him, conferred empowerment with vajra water upon him together with his

retinue. After this, he caused Śakra, lord of the gods, to generate the awakening mind in the Great Vehicle.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, together with his retinue, entered into the great maṇḍala, took refuge in the Three Jewels, and with a mind to offer a guru's gift to the Blessed One, thought: "What shall I offer the Blessed One?" Then Śakra, lord of the gods, touched the two feet of the Blessed One Vairocana, took his own beautiful goddess, and offered her.

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, spoke to Śakra in these words: "Let this woman remain with you yourself."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, please accept her in any case, for my joy. Otherwise, how shall I become your disciple?" Then the Blessed One, moved by this, accepted her accordingly.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, filled with satisfaction and supreme delight, circumambulated the great maṇḍala of the Blessed One Vairocana and Vajrapāṇi many hundreds of thousands of times, and then departed with his retinue.

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, lord of all Tathāgatas, examined that beautiful goddess and conferred empowerment upon her with vajra water. Seeing that she was supremely graceful, he gave her the name Vajra-Grace.

Then Vajra-Dance was summoned, and she was addressed with a formal declaration. The declaration was: "How wonderful is this way of the Great Vehicle, by which one who has attained Tathāgatahood is found to bestow great bliss together with a supremely beautiful form."

Then the Blessed One summoned yet other goddesses and filled the entire maṇḍala with them.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, came there again together with a fourfold army host. Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, seeing the fourfold army host arriving, became greatly agitated in mind and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, who is this that has arrived here — this evil māra with his fourfold army host?"

Then the Blessed One, reflecting, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, this is not an evil māra who has come. Rather, this is Kauśika."

Then Vajrapāṇi, greatly enraged, brandished his vajra and said: "Blessed One, if any have come with a jealous mind, I shall burn them with this vajra."

Then the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, do not do that. He has come to offer yet another guru's gift."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, came forward and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, if you are willing to accept yet another guru's gift, please receive it." The Blessed One declared: "Whatever you wish to give me, let it remain with you yourself. Kauśika, the guru's gift is simply this: keeping to the way of the Great Vehicle." Śakra replied: "Even so, please accept these," and having offered the guru's gift, he circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and then Śakra, lord of the gods, departed with his retinue.

Then others as well, such as Padmabhava and the rest, came and made offerings and departed. Those of the Śrāvaka Vehicle also came and made offerings and departed. As these matters are explained at length in other tantras, they are not set forth here.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, will you please condense the extensive method of practice into a brief summary?"

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, since the account of the Śrāvaka Vehicle has not been told, the cultivation of its meditative absorption will now be taught. Vajrapāṇi, sinful sentient beings are not to be introduced to the Great Vehicle. One should not even bring them to mind."

Then Vajrapāṇi said:

Vajrapāṇi said: "Blessed One, for what reason should one not even bring them to mind?"

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, for as long as one speaks of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the samaya is broken by that very act. Therefore, through firm reliance on the Secret Vehicle, those persons should be kept far away and completely abandoned."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, how should the adherents of the Śrāvaka Vehicle be repulsed?"

The Blessed One then declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, if those who have received empowerment into the great Secret Vehicle should at some point

enter among the adherents of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, those śrāvaka adherents will laugh at them with great derision, crying out loudly: 'Ah, how extraordinary and marvelous is this vehicle!' In that case, a practitioner of the Great Vehicle should demonstrate his power and ability before them."

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, in what manner should one demonstrate power and ability?"

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, there is a vidyā called the Great Illusion. Once it is obtained, one may do whatever one wishes. Vajrapāṇi, this is the vidyā called the Great Illusion:

Namo bhagavate mahāmāye trailokyādāni mahāvidyā ākarṣaṇi mohani
cchedani māraṇi karddhani mahāindrajālakāriṇi devānāṃ aya asurānāṃ
kadha yakṣa rākṣasa gandharva kinnara vidyādhara ākarṣaya ākarṣaya
darśaya darśaya viṣṇu darśaya darśaya brahmaṇāṃ darśaya darśaya
trailokyam darśaya darśaya ānaya ānaya mahāmohe ehyehi bhagavate
mahāmāye anekakuhaka sahasrakule madani jīvanahitārā babhāhūṃle hehe
ruru hara hara prāṇān khāhi khāhi gṛhṇa gṛhṇa pātani bhramaṇi mūrcchani
hūṃ hūṃ haḥ haḥ phaṭ hūṃ haḥ svāhā.

This is the vidyā of Bhagavatī, the Secret One, guarded in secrecy, known as the Vidyā-Net of Great Illusion — the vidyā whose power is efficacious and accomplished in form, the sovereign of the world of the Secret Bhagavatī, the sovereign of all sentient beings, the tamer of all the wicked. The rite for this is as follows: first, the preliminary recitation of one thousand repetitions; then, when the moon is seized by an eclipse, one dwells in fasting by day and by night, and for as long as the eclipse is not seen to have passed and the moon has not been freed, one continues to recite. In the morning one bathes, and one burns twenty-one bilva twigs anointed with butter. Then one holds a feast for brahmins, and by receiving their blessing thereafter, accomplishment will be achieved.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One: "Once this is accomplished, what should one do?"

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, one will be able to perform all actions. Take hold of a peacock feather in its entirety, and by reciting this vidyā-mantra seven times over it with full consecration, that feather will perform a thousand wonders."

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One: "What thousand wonders will it perform?"

The Blessed One then declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, if anyone reviles the Great Vehicle, that person is to be subdued directly on the spot. If the feather is waved in the sky, all the gods dwelling in the sky will be made to appear. If the feather is held up high into the sky, Brahmā, Viṣṇu, the Great God (Śiva), Śakra (Indra), the Moon, yakṣas, rākṣasas, and

asuras, garuḍas, and kiṃnaras along with their many fine mansions will be made to appear in the sky. If Vajrapāṇi holds the feather aloft, all those conjunctions will be severed.

"Vajrapāṇi, there is another application to be described. Recite this vidyā-mantra fully over any water that swirls in a circle, then cast it into the sky, and clouds descending with rain will be made to appear. Wave the feather upward, and they will all vanish once more.

"There is yet another application to be described. Recite the mantra a little over ashes and scatter them in the midst of a town, a city, or the like, and that town and the rest will be shown to burn. Wave the feather upward, and they will be pacified again.

"Vajrapāṇi, there is yet another application to be described. When a mantra-practitioner is journeying in a remote place and encounters bandits or the like, he should take up a handful of sand, recite the vidyā-mantra a few times over it, and scatter it in the four directions. An army host of thousands of elephants, horses, and the like will appear to be seen. Then those malevolent sentient beings such as bandits, filled with alarm, will not venture near. Wave the feather upward, and they will vanish.

"Vajrapāṇi, with that same feather one may summon a woman from afar and enjoy her as one desires. Vajrapāṇi, if one wishes to slay a malevolent being, one should, through that same feather's application, in a state of fierce anger, pronounce that being's name and wave the feather over it, and he will die — indeed, he will die again and again. With that same feather, whatever material goods one has in mind will come forth. With it too, the spells of rival mantra-practitioners will be broken. And again, by waving that same feather upward, one will be released from them. With it one can summon any woman one desires. One who has been eaten by a great flesh-devouring creature will be saved and restored to life. One who has been bitten by a black snake will be revived, and even the most unbearable poison will be eliminated. All

epidemics and diseases whatsoever will be pacified by means of the feather. It performs whatever deeds have not been described. Reciting it constantly, one will be victorious over death.

"Vajrapāṇi, these then are the methods of accomplishment for the vidyā-mantra called Great Illusion. By this very method the entire world may be brought under sway. This is a vidyā-mantra that strikes fear into the followers of the śrāvaka vehicle; it does not accomplish buddhahood itself. Buddhahood is not achieved in the slightest by mantra-practice alone — it is achieved through the sequential stages of meditation. It is accomplished through the sequential stages of meditation endowed with the mode of secrecy.

"Vajrapāṇi, therefore, for the delight of worldly people, a mantra-practitioner should pursue these minor accomplishments — not for the sake of buddhahood."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, if buddhahood cannot be achieved by means of mantra alone, by what means does one achieve buddhahood? I wish to understand."

Then the Blessed One declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, by practicing in the mode of secrecy, one will accomplish buddhahood and attain unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening."

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, lord of all Tathāgatas, declared to the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, listen! O Lord of Supreme Secrets: one who abandons the Great Vehicle cannot achieve buddhahood by any other means even in ten billion eons."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, please declare the mode of the Great Vehicle — that by which buddhahood is bestowed upon all sentient beings."

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, the Great Vehicle is called the supreme treasury of secrets. Listen!"

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what is the meaning of the word 'treasury'?"

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, what is called the 'treasury' here is the abiding place that is the foundation of the bhaga. One should unite the petitioner with that treasury and visualize oneself in the form of Vajrasattva."

Then the great Blessed One Vairocana, together with Vajrapāṇi, Vajranṛtya, and Vajralāsyā, performed many kinds of embraces and kisses and the like, and partook of the drink.

Then Vajrapāṇi, in the manner of a mantra-practitioner, entering within the bhaga by means of kissing, embracing, and the like, should generate himself, through the fivefold awakening, as one who has fully awakened in the form of Vajrasattva.

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, is it impossible to cultivate the fivefold full awakening while remaining outside?"

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, remaining outside, or by means of an external mode, or by merely relying on the bhaga — one is not able to accomplish awakening. However, if one relies on the bhaga with this practice, one will become a cultivator of the fivefold full awakening."

"Blessed One, how should one meditate?"

"Vajrapāṇi, through the root-petitioner one should visualize oneself in the form of a lunar maṇḍala. Then, uniting all the channels of the awakening-moon into one, one should meditate, seeing oneself as the awakening-moon. From that milk one should conceive of oneself as having the form of a vajra, and from that one should fully meditate on the body of Vajrasattva. Then, from all of these having become united as one, one should meditate on the body of all the Tathāgatas. One will thereby become equal to the great Vairocana, lord of all Tathāgatas."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, is it impossible to cultivate the fivefold full awakening by any means other than these root practices?"

Then the Blessed One declared to the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, it is precisely by these root practices that one cultivates the fivefold full awakening — not by any other means."

Vajrapāṇi asked: "Why is that?"

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, full awakening through the form of an external lunar maṇḍala is impossible — even with great effort, not even the slightest can be accomplished. It is like a lotus growing in the sky, which cannot be accomplished by any means whatsoever. That is why it is called 'secret.' Through this mode of secrecy, buddhahood — that is, the state of

Vajradhara — is to be accomplished without hardship, and not by any other practice. Therefore, the Blessed One, the Sugata, resplendent as the sun of the bindu, for the benefit of all sentient beings, has made this very secret practice clear."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, and yet you have not fully spoken to me the correct mode of the secret practice."

Then the great Blessed One Vairocana declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, listen to what is called the bindu of the supreme treasury of secrets — that which bestows all buddhahood, that which is the generative source of all Tathāgatas. I too have accomplished buddhahood through this mode, and —"

"And you too shall accomplish buddhahood by this very mode."

Then the Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, for as long as the pores of body hair exist, meditate upon the channels as forms of infinitesimally fine particles. Then, having visualized them in the form of the Vajra Dancer, conceive of the nature of that form — arising from the essential nature of the channels at the center of the bhaga — as the falling of letters beginning with A. After that, conceive of the five non-flowing channels as forms beginning with Ka. From their complete transformation, visualize a lunar maṇḍala, and from its fluid conceive of oneself in the form of Vajrasattva (the bodhisattva of vajra) at the center of the bhaga.

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, what is the form and the intrinsic nature of those channels?"

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, among all those channels, one is the great channel, the principal one, and all other channels abide in dependence upon it. Its intrinsic nature is of a cool nature. One who finds it will attain the very state of Vajrapāṇi or the state of Vairocana. Whoever has that which is slightly warm will, through it, attain the form of the Lord of the World (Avalokiteśvara). Whoever is endowed with that which is extremely warm, and meditates upon it, will come to embody Vajrahūṃkāra. Having then transformed into the wrathful form, one meditates for as long as that wrathful form endures, and combined with the peaceful form, that is then the solar maṇḍala."

Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, is buddhahood attained by the mere resort to a woman, or also by other

means?"

The Blessed One declared: "Apart from resort to a woman who possesses the practice, buddhahood cannot be attained by anything else whatsoever. Everything else is only distraction.

Therefore, Vajrapāṇi, the mantra practitioner, upon finding a goddess, should seat her upon his thighs, embrace her and so forth, thoroughly resort to her, drink, and let that too be absorbed drop by drop. Then, uniting the fluid of that channel at the center of the bhaga with oneself, meditate by means of one's own king of mantras — conceiving oneself as desire itself — and continue to meditate in the form of Vajrasattva, in a white appearance.

Vajrapāṇi, therefore that single channel is the mother of all buddhas. In terms of an outer mode of expression, that very thing is called the Perfection of Wisdom. All buddhas are born from it. Therefore, Vajrapāṇi, by the mere drinking of a stream of that fluid, the form of Vajrasattva is fully attained.

Vajrapāṇi, further, let this be explained. The drops endowed with flowing fluid from the channels dwelling in the pores of body hair abide, distinguished and exalted, in three locations. At the crown of the head, in a vessel form bearing the character of nectar, conceive of it as having the nature of nectar and as dripping nectar. Furthermore, at the place of the heart, conceive of a lotus form, white in color, comparable to fresh butter and fully fresh, such that merely the dripping of the vessel's nectar causes the lotus to blossom. Then at the secret place, conceive of the form of the letter E — triangular, adorned with various colors, arising from the complete transformation of letters beginning with Ka — as a single stream of nectar flowing forth through the openings of the five channels. And from that stream of nectar, meditate upon oneself as the inseparable form of Vajrasattva, of the very nature of nectar."

Vajrapāṇi, for this reason, of all the channels that one is the principal, and it is that very one which bestows buddhahood. Therefore, if one meditates in this manner, one will become inseparable from the essential nature of nectar. In this very body, the white hairs and wrinkles will be cast off, and one will behold the forms of the Sugatas. One will also see oneself as a reflected image. Remaining here, one will come to know the karmas of an entire cosmic age. Vajrapāṇi, for this reason one should meditate on this.

Vajrapāṇi, when a woman meditates in this way, if in a dream Vajrasattva confers empowerment, know from that point that accomplishment will come within half a month. If instead it is an accomplished master who appears and

gives instruction, know from that point that accomplishment will come within six months. If at some juncture one is led into a divine palace and beholds the reflected image of a Tathāgata, know from that point that accomplishment will come within one year. Then, if while dwelling in a divine palace one sees oneself blazing through the practice of the cūṣaṇa and so forth, know from that point that swift accomplishment will follow. If at some juncture one perceives luminous appearance, know from that that accomplishment will come in this very life. Or, if in a dream one sees the embrace of the bhaga, the āliṅga, and the cūṣaṇa, know from that that the person will attain accomplishment — accomplishment will come without effort.

Vajrapāṇi, therefore the mantra practitioner should purify himself in the root practice of the channels through the fivefold sequence of manifest awakening that is endowed with the cūṣaṇa and the rest. Because the letter E takes on various forms — for example, if one meditates on it as red in color, in the form of Vajrahūṃkāra, one thereby brings all sentient beings under one's power. If one then wishes to slay, at that time one meditates upon the form of the dark channel as Vajrahūṃkāra, oneself black in color, and by that one effects the slaying. If one then wishes to expel, one meditates on oneself in the form of Vajrahūṃkāra as previously described, and gazes upon the object of the action as riding on a female dog; by that one expels and dispatches the object to another place.

Vajrapāṇi, therefore all actions are entirely dependent upon the secret. Know then that this is secret beyond even the secret. Through this very root practice of the channels one accomplishes buddhahood itself, or vajradhārahood. Those who abide in merely external forms are like donkeys — know that they carry loads to no fruit.

Vajrapāṇi, therefore come to know these things, and act for the benefit of sentient beings. I too abide in this way. Vajrapāṇi, know the thoughts of all sentient beings and teach them the Dharma. Otherwise, if even you were to engage in contrary conduct, what need is there to speak of other sentient beings? In a different tantra the letter E is explained according to its meaning. Here, by the way of the external forms, through the manner of the ten root channels one should understand the ten suchnesses. But in the ultimate sense, the suchnesses are neither ten nor five — the singular alone is ultimate. That which is the principal of the channels without remainder or residue, the bestower of buddhahood itself — whoever attains it goes to buddhahood, and beings will proceed to their respective destinations. This is not explained in

detail in other tantras.

Vajrapāṇi, having made clear to you this yoga, the great yoga, the great secret, and the secret root practice of the channels, now offer the teacher's fee to me. As for those other than a noble one who are pre-eminent teachers of the Great Vehicle, they should certainly offer the teacher's fee even up to and including one's own body — what need is there to speak of others? Vajrapāṇi, do not let your mind waver.

...will become utterly intoxicated. Then Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what shall I offer? Is there anything whatsoever that is not already complete in you?" The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, although everything is complete, an offering is still to be made." Vajrapāṇi asked: "What shall I offer?" The Blessed One declared: "These are what are to be offered: do not explain the intention of this teaching to sentient beings who lack the good fortune for it. Never show even the physical volume of this tantra to those who follow the vehicle of the śrāvakas, and do not even utter its name clearly in their presence."

Vajrapāṇi then said: "Blessed One, I will not explain it to those who follow the vehicle of the śrāvakas, nor will I remain in their presence. But if I do remain in their presence and do explain it, what will happen to me? Blessed One, why do you not make this clear to me?" The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, have you forgotten what was explained earlier about the nature of the Great Vehicle? Vajrapāṇi, it is not only followers of the śrāvaka vehicle — even other sentient beings, even mantra practitioners, and even all the Tathāgatas: if they were to come to know this secret, they would at that very moment be born from Vajra-Elegance and Vajra-Dance. Know that whatever I am like and whatever you are like, they would become just like that."

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, this root practice, which is the extremely profound method that contains all secrets — how will sentient beings come to seek it? Should I teach it to them or not?" Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, declared to Vajrapāṇi: "Vajrapāṇi, you too must not reveal this tantra clearly to disciples or to mantra practitioners." Vajrapāṇi asked: "Blessed One, what do you mean? Should I not reveal it even to mantra practitioners who have received the empowerment of the secret?" The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, for those sentient beings who have an excellent disposition of faith, who wish to come to know this tantra — to all of them, after they have

performed the offering of the great secret through the practices of intimate union with a woman, the cūṣaṇa and so forth, along with the accompanying instructions, you should teach it with earnest effort. But if there are those who bear hostility toward this tantra, then while abiding in the form of Vajra Hūṃkāra, blazing with great wrath in the manner of Vajra Hūṃkāra, you should visualize his dwelling place ablaze. Thereupon, he together with his retinue will be destroyed. However, if the mantra practitioner wishes to restore them, then by visualizing the vajra families of nectar-nature upon that half-burned dwelling place, they will be revived. Vajrapāṇi, for this reason, do not explain this to just anyone at all."

This concludes the elaborate ritual of the hidden suchness of the entire teaching, from the tantra called the Supreme Secret Treasury of the Bindu.

Then the Blessed One, the great Vairocana, having established all the Tathāgatas in steadiness, caused those bodies of Vajrapāṇi to become one, and on the northern shore of that ocean, at the northern boundary of Jambudvīpa, he remained together with Vajra-Elegance and Vajra-Dance, engaging in the previously described practices of embrace, clasping, and so forth in the sport of a great king, dwelling in the station of Vajra-Elegance and Vajra-Dance together with two thousand five hundred queens, each of five hundred thrones, adorned with all ornaments, pleasing and beautiful.

Then Vajrapāṇi asked: "What are the names of these?" The Blessed One declared: "These abide in four aspects:

The first is she who is called the Sovereign Yoginī Beautiful Youth, white in color, bearing the form of two hundred years, surrounded by ten thousand Sovereign Yoginīs. She dwells at the place called the Mountain in the field of Jālandhara, and she perpetually comes and goes to wherever the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi abides.

The second is she who is called the Sovereign Yoginī Intoxicated by Desire, blue-green in color with wide-open eyes, together with thirty-five thousand Sovereign Yoginīs. She dwells at the gateway leading into Mount Kīkiṇḍhari on the southern range, and whenever Vajrapāṇi teaches the secret Dharma, she perpetually comes and goes before him.

The third is she who is called the Sovereign Yoginī Golden-Eyed, white in color, dwelling at the gateway of Kāmarūpa together with a retinue of thirty thousand. She likewise perpetually comes and goes in the same manner.

The fourth is she who is called the Sovereign Yoginī Rejoicing in All Pleasures, abiding everywhere, bearing all forms, dwelling in the manner of loving-kindness toward all, together with a retinue of many tens of millions of thousands. Whenever the secret mantras are taught, she abides in the presence of whoever teaches them. For this reason she is called Rejoicing in All Pleasures.

Now, the Sovereign Yoginī called Beautiful Youth is to be relied upon for as long as she directly and manifestly bestows buddhahood in the manner of Vajrapāṇi.

If one wishes to kill, one should meditate upon that very goddess blazing with fire, dark in color, holding all manner of weapons in her hands; by this even an army with its four divisions may be slain.

If one wishes to drive away, one should visualize that same goddess in a color that is slightly reddish and blue, unyoked from the wind, whereby by her alliance with the maṇḍala of wind the driving away occurs in that very instant.

If one wishes to bring under one's power, one should visualize the goddess in red and summon her; in that instant she will come to the foot of one's legs.

If one wishes to paralyze, one should visualize the goddess as yellow, meditate upon the object to be accomplished as if pierced by iron, and even an army with its four divisions will be paralyzed.

All these are to be accomplished through mental visualization alone.

Vajrapāṇi, there is also a food to be described. By merely eating it, white hair and wrinkles are eliminated and one will live for a hundred thousand years. It is as follows: take a fine raven's nest with its fat, remove the skin, render it finely, and cook the flesh in an iron vessel with sesame oil. Combine it with ten srangs of sugar and twenty srangs of milk, mix them together, and cook until the sound of the raven is no longer heard. Then consume it for seven days together with butter and sugar. White hair of a hundred years will be gone, the body will become like that of a bee, firm and powerful. One will live for five hundred years.

Now the ritual of essence-extraction is to be described. The mantrin, having entered into meditative equipoise, should visualize the very milk of Vajra-Elegance, and should meditate upon himself as fully satisfied. Thereupon all afflictions are pacified. At times one should visualize oneself as the Sovereign of Yoga and drink its fluid. At times, having actualized this directly,

one should take a woman and, through that very samādhi, drink together one's own and her fluid. Thereafter one will become inseparable from the vajra body. This concludes the extensive ritual of essence-extraction.

Then the Blessed One, great Vairocana, the lord of all Tathāgatas, together with —

all the Sovereigns of Yoga, and having made them one with the body of Vajrapāṇi, he became the very body of Vajrapāṇi. Then the great king Vajrapāṇi gazed upon all those goddesses with eyes full of delight. Thereupon all those Sovereigns of the Yoginīs looked upon Vajrapāṇi and spoke these words: "Blessed One, when sentient beings enter into the way of the secret, how will they attain unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening?"

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi declared to them: "Through the way of the secret as practiced before, one should accomplish buddhahood itself."

Then the Sovereign of the Yoginīs known as Lovely Young Woman addressed the Blessed One who is without beginning and without end: "Do those sentient beings become buddhas by the mere resort to the bhaga alone, or is it by meditating upon its secret?"

Then the great king Vajrapāṇi declared to them: "Having accomplished it through the stages of meditation, one should thereafter, by means of a mind free from conceptuality, demonstrate it, and should meditate upon oneself as the body of Vajrapāṇi, or the body of Vairocana, or the body of Īśvara (the Lord of the World), or the body of Vajrahūṃkāra, or the body of the god of desire. From the milk of that very channel, one should meditate upon the form of a lunar maṇḍala, and from that lunar maṇḍala should meditate upon oneself as the body of Vajrasattva, or as the body of one's own deity. That very channel should be imagined as dark in color, and from it one should meditate upon oneself as the body of Vajrahūṃkāra. That very channel should be meditated upon as having the graduated form of a reddish hue, and from that one should meditate upon oneself as the body of Īśvara, distinguished by the categories of karma. That very channel should be meditated upon as of a clear blue color, like space, and from it one should meditate upon oneself as the body of Sharp Vajra. Then, through the conjunction of those channels distinguished by the categories of karma, if one meditates upon oneself in that way, accomplishment will without doubt be attained. Thereafter the mantra practitioner, having meditated with undistracted mind at the four sessions, will attain accomplishment in just six months."

Then the Sovereign of the Yoginīs known as Lovely Young Woman addressed the great king Vajrapāṇi: "Blessed One, how do those sentient beings perform the actions of summoning and the like?"

Then the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi declared to her: "If the mantra practitioner wishes to summon a person, he should meditate upon himself as having a slightly whitish form, a wrathful countenance, and six arms at the center of her bhaga, combined with the subtle sound of that very union. By means of that vajra, he should pierce the heart of the one to be accomplished, bind the throat with a noose, hook that person with an iron hook, draw him in, and so meditate. In that way, even kings can be summoned — how much more the common people of towns and so on! If a knowledge-holder is to be summoned, how much more easily a king! Then, if one wishes to bring a woman under one's power, one should meditate upon oneself as having the form of Hayagrīva in red color by means of the fire of the subtle-sound union at the center of the bhaga. When that vajra pierces the heart of that great goddess, she will come even from a distance of fifty leagues in a state of intoxication — how much more those dwelling at the edge of a town or the boundary of a house! By this same means, if one summons the wife of a knowledge-holder, or the wife of a gandharva, or the wife of a yakṣa, or the wife of the lord of the three worlds, or even the wife of Śakra (Indra), then the great goddesses of great kings —

let alone the daughters of a town — what need is said of them? One must not apply a superior union to an inferior, nor an inferior union to a superior, for the samaya vow would be broken. Nor is one able to accomplish superior aims by means of an inferior union, since it is not the appropriate limb for that. If one then remains in some direction and practices the secret union day and night, accomplishment will come in exactly six months; one will see the beings of an aeon, hear voices that have endured long, and ultimately attain buddhahood itself — of this there is no doubt. Just as with the sādhana of the great goddess of the Vajra-Coquette lineage, so too should Vajra-Coquette herself be accomplished in the same way, in accordance with the preceding sequence. By this very union one should summon those sovereign yoginīs as well, and rely upon them. Those sovereign yoginīs together with their retinues then bowed at the feet of Vajrapāṇi and addressed him thus: "Blessed One, by this very method may we too attain accomplishment."

Then the sovereign yoginī called Intoxicated by Desire addressed Vajrapāṇi in these words: "Blessed One, whosoever constantly relies upon me by means of

the vajra request — may I go ahead of that mantra-holder, may he take me as his own, and may I follow after him."

Then the sovereign yoginī called Golden-Eyed addressed him in these words: "Blessed One, whosoever enters into the midst of my bhaga and constantly relies upon me — I will become that one's servant, remain there always, and never again come and go on my own account."

Then the sovereign yoginī called Pleasing to All Beings addressed the Blessed One, who is without beginning and without end, in these words: "Blessed One, whosoever comes to think of me and remember me always in the manner of the secret, or causes me to be remembered — may I, without fail, bestow upon that one buddhahood itself."

Then Vajrapāṇi declared to those sovereign yoginīs: "Whatever sentient being has entered into this way of the Great Vehicle should be empowered by this elixir-extraction practice. Iron powder and the roots of atibalā and mahābalā should be combined with milk and made sweet with sugar, and one should live upon this. Then the yogin should consume it with the appropriate rite. One should also eat food of meat and butter. Endowed thereafter with great strength, one will not be tainted by evil."

Now another matter will be explained. In the domain of space or in another domain, one should meditate upon the vajra wheel endowed with eight vajras, which is like a lunar maṇḍala with the nature of nectar, in order to empower oneself. By this one will be endowed with great strength. Then, for the purpose of slaying, one should meditate upon that very vajra wheel blazing and bright, radiating tongues of flame, descending upon the dwelling, the town or the city of the target — at that very instant the target together with the entire lineage will be destroyed. Then, for the purpose of bringing under one's power, one should meditate upon that same wheel, the color of red bandhu or like the color of the jāvā flower, pervading all directions, summoning the one to be accomplished — and that one will come under one's power. By this same practice of the vajra wheel, kings, ministers, court heralds, and the like will also come under one's power. Then, if one wishes to summon the great goddess of a king, one should visualize that very vajra wheel as red, and —

one should place it upon that wheel, and meditate on it being driven by the wind and striking at the feet of that one — and within that very day and night, it will summon her.

Then the great bodhisattva king Vajrapāṇi gathered the assembly once more, and spoke thus to all the Tathāgatas, beginning with Vajra-Mohinī: "If there is some mantra-practitioner who does not meditate upon the meaning of this tantra, even so, he should keep it as a written scripture in his home. And one should know that he abides in this way of practice. Whoever meditates with reverence going before him shall be known as one who is like Vajrasattva. This must not be explained to just anyone — and why? Because there exist certain beings with malicious intent, and it must not be explained in their presence. A master should first confer the empowerment of the secret upon a disciple who resembles a Vajradhara, making him a student, and only then explain it — not otherwise. That student, for his part, should make a lunar maṇḍala of sandalwood, invite the master to be seated therein, adorn him with ornaments and all manner of finery as one would the Blessed One Vairocana, and then offer praise and the like."

Therefore this must never be told even as a mere account to those of the vehicle of hearers and the like, nor should even the text itself be shown to them. One should enjoy it and abide in it together, in unity with those of this very vehicle, and not engage in any conceptuality whatsoever.

This concludes the section on the secret source, called "The Supreme Bindu Concealing the Secret Suchness," from the Great Vehicle Sūtra known as "The Treasury of Supreme Secrets," taught by the Blessed One to Vajrapāṇi.

This sacred tantra, in this land of snow,
was not found before in any form at all.

The learned Palsang Sugata (Bde-bźar-gśegs-pa'i-dpal) and
Dra-rig Kunga Gyaltsen — I translated it.

Urged by a sacred command, and with reverence,
I translated it at the glorious Sakya temple.

By this virtue, may all sentient beings
understand the secret meaning and reach the ground of buddhahood.

Translator's Notes

- The title Āryaguhyamaṇītilakā nāma sūtra is rendered directly from the Sanskrit provided in the text. The Tibetan title འདུག་གཏུག་གཏུག་འཁོར་ལྔ་པ་ཀློང་པ་ means literally "Secret Jewel Drop" or "Secret Jewel Dot"; "dot" or "drop" both work for འཁོར་ལྔ་པ་ in this context; I have used "Jewel-Dot" to stay close to tilaka, which can denote a dot or mark, though it also means "ornament."

The passage ends mid-sentence at the maṇḍala of sunbeams, as the source text itself breaks off at that point.

Ākāśagarbha (ཨ་ཀ་ཤ་ག་ར་པ་མ་) and Gaṇaṁṛtaḥ (ག་ཀ་ཤ་ག་ར་པ་མ་) are two distinct bodhisattvas; the former is well attested, while the latter's Sanskrit reconstruction is approximate.

- The verse section in the middle of this passage is an enumeration of epithets and qualities of a great bodhisattva assembly-figure, most likely Vajrapāṇi in his cosmic aspect, though the epithets range widely across the Śaiva, yakṣa, and Buddhist deity pantheons. "Ākāśagarbha" renders ཨ་ཀ་ཤ་ག་ར་པ་མ་, which is both an epithet and the name of the bodhisattva Ākāśagarbha. "Lord of Umā" is an epithet absorbed from Śiva as consort of the goddess Umā, here applied to the figure being praised within the Buddhist tantric synthesis. The final verse is spoken in the first person by the Blessed One Vairocana addressing Vajrasattva, expressing a kind of sacred paradox: he who has fully realized the secret absorption nonetheless enacts the ritual of requesting it, modeling the samaya for the benefit of beings.

- The phrase translated as "mounted the great elephant of the Great Vehicle" renders a Tibetan idiom in which the Great Vehicle is likened to a great elephant — a standard analogy for the Mahāyāna as a vehicle of vast capacity. The rendering follows this imagery directly.

The term "divine rank" renders the Tibetan for the class or category of deities within the maṇḍala hierarchy, referring to those who have been properly initiated and assigned their station. Those who have not seen this rank — that is, who have not entered the maṇḍala through empowerment — and who disparage the sacred pledge would cause grave harm to themselves merely by encountering even a description of these teachings.

- The passage contains a liturgical section mid-translation that transitions from narrative prose into a formal ritual manual with embedded mantra text and a verse vow-generation formula. The mantra OM SVABHĀVAŚUDDHĀḤ SARVADHARMĀḤ SVABHĀVAŚUDDHO 'HAM is the well-known purification mantra of the Madhyamaka tradition, here transliterated directly from the Tibetan phonetic rendering; the Sanskrit has been standardly reconstructed.

The phrase rendered "Drop of the Supremely Secret" translates "shin tu ches gsang ba'i thig le," where thig le (Skt. bindu) can mean drop, sphere, or seminal point; "Drop" is chosen for the tantric register. This is a title of the text or teaching being transmitted.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the Tibetan source provided, so the translation likewise breaks off there accordingly.

- The fourfold gift mentioned in the vajra family section refers to the four kinds of giving traditional in tantric contexts: material gifts, fearlessness, Dharma, and loving-kindness. This is not glossed in the source but is a standard tantric formulation.

The passage places Vajrapāṇi simultaneously in several positions relative to Vairocana (to the left, in his heart, behind him), which reflects the maṇḍala's symbolic logic rather than literal spatial description. No emendation is needed; the text is internally consistent within the tantric ritual-visualization frame.

The vowel series listed corresponds to the Sanskrit vowel alphabet as rendered in Tibetan transliteration; the enumeration here is a standard tantric seed-syllable meditation on the Sanskrit vowels as aspects of luminous mind.

- The phrase rendered "union of reflected images" translates gzugs brnyan gyi sbyor ba, a technical tantric term for the yogic technique of superimposing one's own form upon the reflection-like image of the deity — the translation captures the sense clearly enough for a general listener, though specialists may prefer "the yoga of reflected images."

The syllable sequence ka kha ga gha ṇa etc. represents the full Sanskrit syllabary (varṇamālā) as traditionally enumerated in Indo-Tibetan tantric literature; the passage is presenting the alphabet itself as entering the forms of stars and other luminous bodies to constitute the moon maṇḍala.

- The five tathāgatas are positioned around the central Bodhisattva Vajra figure as a maṇḍala arrangement: the Lord of all Tathāgatas (Vairocana) above, Akṣobhya at the brow, Ratnasambhava to the right, Amitābha behind, and Amoghasiddhi to the left. This is a standard tantric crown-of-the-five-buddhas configuration described iconographically.

The mantras are rendered in reconstructed Sanskrit from the Tibetan phonetic transcription; minor orthographic variants are typical of Tibetan transliteration of Sanskrit dhāraṇī syllables.

- The colophon-like line ending the first section marks the conclusion of what appears to be a distinct chapter or section within the Vajratilaka Tantra, specifically the portion treating individual awareness of mind. The title rendered as "the King of Tantras called the Great Secret, the Vajratilaka" follows the Tibetan closely: gsang ba chen po rtog pa'i rgyal po rdo rje thig le.

The one hundred and eight names hymn begins mid-passage and the translation ends where the Tibetan passage ends, mid-stanza. This is consistent with the passage as supplied.

The epithet "Meaningful King" renders don yod rgyal po, a name also associated with Amoghasiddhi; here it functions as one of the vajra-names within the hymn of praise.

- The phrase rendered "Vajra Boundary, excellently approached" translates a term that in tantric Vinaya contexts can mean "Vajra limit" or "Vajra enclosure" — the sense of a properly observed sacred boundary. This reading is consistent with its pairing with "Vajra Binding, supremely liberating," both of which evoke the tantric structure of commitment and liberation.

The description of Vairocana as simultaneously "father of all the Tathāgatas" and "mother of all the Tathāgatas" reflects a standard tantric formulation in which Vairocana encompasses both generative principles of the buddha-families; it is not a textual anomaly.

- The passage "the master called 'Secret'" renders a name or epithet, Gsang ba, meaning literally "Secret" or "the Secret One," which appears to function as the name of the primordial master who empowered Vairocana. This is a notable doctrinal point: Vairocana himself is said to have received empowerment from a figure named or epithetized as "Secret," suggesting a higher or primordial source of the transmission.

The phrase rendered "drops of milk endowed with rays of light" translates a technically dense tantric image. The expression may refer to seminal or luminous drops in the subtle body, though the exact ritual or yogic referent is not fully explicit in this passage alone.

- The simile of the kimśuka fruit refers to the Butea monosperma tree, whose blossoms are vivid red and visually striking but are said to be odorless or insubstantial — here applied to practitioners whose external appearance suggests spiritual capacity but whose inner quality is hollow. This is a classical Indian literary comparison found in several Buddhist and non-Buddhist texts.

The phrase rendered "union" for sbyor ba carries a deliberate double meaning in tantric context: it can mean "practice" or "application" in general usage, but here the pairing with mudrā, the goddess, and the explicit contrast with mere verbal mantras strongly implies ritual or meditative union in the tantric sense. The translation preserves the ambiguity naturally present in the Tibetan without forcing an overly explicit reading.

- The term rendered "secret lotus" translates the Sanskrit bhaga, the female generative organ, here given in transliteration in the Tibetan. The text is unambiguous and the translation preserves the literal sense, which is standard in this genre of tantra.

The epithet "Blessed Lady" for the feminine deity Vajragāndhārī renders bcom ldan 'das ma, the feminine form of Bhagavān, a recognized honorific for high tantric goddesses in this corpus.

The figure Vajra-Hūṃkāra is both a wrathful deity and, in this passage, takes on a quasi-narrative role as a character who speaks and is addressed; the translation preserves that ambiguity without smoothing it.

- The final rhetorical question is a pointed contrast between the outer or exoteric ritual path just described and the inner Mahāyāna understanding. The phrasing implies that practitioners of the Great Vehicle are not dependent on or fully satisfied by these outer methods alone, hinting at a higher esoteric or philosophical dimension. The sentence is slightly compressed in the Tibetan and admits of slightly varying readings, but this rendering captures the doctrinal intent.

The long mantra passage contains transliterated Sanskrit preserved directly from the Tibetan phonetic rendering. Some syllables show minor orthographic irregularities typical of such Tibetan transcriptions, but the passage has been rendered as faithfully as possible without emendation.

- The mudrā descriptions in the verse section involve highly technical finger-gesture terminology. The rendering follows the most natural anatomical reading: "nameless ones" are the ring fingers, "middle fingers" are the middle fingers, and "thumbs" are the thumbs. The verse form is maintained as in the source.

The passage includes explicit sexual yoga language in the tantric accomplishment ritual. The term bhaga is a Sanskrit loanword used directly in the Tibetan and is rendered as such; it denotes the female sexual organ. The phrase "root face" in "root face's lips" translates rtsa ba'i gdong, which in this context likely refers to the mouth of the consort at the level of the face rather than a genital euphemism, though some ambiguity exists.

The phrase rendered "even one such as I" has Vairocana speaking in the first person, which is somewhat unusual and may reflect a teaching device or a textual nuance worth noting.

- The term rendered "Vajragandharī" is a deity name in the tantric corpus; her name means "Vajra-Fragrance Lady." The bhaga reference is anatomical-ritual terminology standard in this class of tantra and is translated literally. The practice described — subjugation, killing, expulsion, and liberation — belongs to the four or more ritual activities of tantric accomplishment and is presented here in doctrinal context without editorial softening, in keeping with the source.

"Vajrahūṃkāra" is a wrathful tantric deity whose name derives from the seed-syllable HŪṂ; the name is kept in Sanskrit as it is a proper deity name with no standard English rendering.

The phrase rendered "the Blessed Lady" for the female deity follows the honorific use of Bhagavatī implied by the construction; the Tibetan gives "Bcom ldan 'das ma," the feminine form of Bhagavān.

- The passage contains explicit sexual yoga instructions typical of early Mahāyoga tantric literature. The term "bhaga" (rendered as "secret lotus") refers anatomically to the female sexual organ and is used here in its standard tantric technical sense; the translation follows traditional euphemistic rendering appropriate for a general audience while preserving doctrinal accuracy. The phrase "Lord of the World" (Lokēśvara) is used here as a name for Avalokiteśvara; the text treats these as interchangeable, which is consistent with early Guhyasamāja-cycle and Mahāvairocana-cycle usage. The final sentence breaks off mid-passage as the source text does, indicating this is a continuation passage.

- The section heading marks the close of a distinct chapter: "The extended ritual procedure of

the tantra of the goddesses from the great royal tantra of the supreme secret treasury, the Deliberating King, is hereby completely fulfilled." This is a chapter-colophon embedded in the text, rendered as prose since it functions as a closing declaration.

The term rendered "flowing essence" throughout is *zhuba*, a technical tantric euphemism for sexual fluid; the translation preserves the register without clinical bluntness, consistent with the preceding passage.

The phrase "all goddess vidyās" renders rig pa'i lha mo thams cad — vidyā goddesses being feminine tantric deity-principles associated with mantra knowledge; "knowledge goddesses" and "goddess vidyās" are used to preserve both senses.

- The phrase rendered "the vowel letters beginning with A are established in the manner of non-arising" reflects a standard Vajrayāna meditation on the Sanskrit vowels as representing emptiness or the unborn nature, while the consonants beginning with Ka represent the amṛta principle. The term translated "non-arising" for the vowels is implied by the context of the A syllable meditation; the Tibetan literally says "established in the manner of being without vowel letters beginning with A," which in this technical context means that the A-vowel class dissolves into the unborn, hence "non-arising" captures the doctrinal intent. This is a well-attested tantric meditative convention.
- The phrases involving the consonant syllables Ka, Ṭha, Ṭa, and Ṇa reflect a tantra-internal phonemic exegesis in which individual syllables of the Sanskrit alphabet are etymologized to yield doctrinal meanings. The world-realm name rendered as "the Resounding of Ka" is a provisional translation of a syllable-name. The compound "Tāṭa-Maṭa" in the Ṭha passage is a phonemic gloss term left in transliterated form as it appears to be a technical syllabic construct without an established English equivalent. The verse section "the mothers — the Prajñās — praised the lord of all Tathāgatas" introduces the Prajñā-mothers as a class of wisdom-deity interlocutors; their praise-hymn follows directly. The final verse is incomplete in the supplied passage, ending mid-line.
- The passage shifts mid-verse from metrical exposition into prose commentary, a typical feature of tantric literature where root verse and explanatory prose alternate without explicit marker. The phrase rendered "recalling the suchness of Dharma" (chos kyi de nyid rjes dran pas) could also be read as "through post-meditative recollection of the suchness of Dharma," but the instructional context favors the simpler rendering. The phrase "the one who bestows the very certainty of being Vajrasattva" is a compressed construction; the Tibetan literally says "the one who certainly bestows Vajrasattvahood itself was drawn forth," referring to the emanated form.
- The phrase rendered "subtle sentient beings" translates རྒྱུ་སྤྲོད་བློ་གྲོས་པ་, literally "fine or subtle sentient beings." In context this refers to the non-human beings — gods, ḍākīṇīs, planetary spirits — who have just been summoned; "subtle" may carry a sense of their being invisible or fine-bodied rather than coarse-bodied humans.
- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, so the translation likewise concludes mid-sentence. The term rendered "lord of the three worlds" translates the Tibetan epithet for Śiva as the claimed universal sovereign; the text plays on the irony of his pretension versus his actual defeat. The phrase "blazing vajra-body whose radiance equaled that of twelve thousand million suns" renders a compound describing Vajrapāṇi's wrathful emanation-body in terms of cosmic brilliance. The "threefold iron fence" is a literal rendering of the Tibetan iron enclosure; this detail is consistent with Śiva-subjugation narratives in the Mahāvairocana tradition.
- The passage "༄༅༆༏༐༑༒༓༔༕༖༗༘༙༚༛༜༝༞༟༠༡༢༣༣༥༦༧༨༩༊་༌།༎༏༐༑༒༓༔༕༖༗༘༙༚༛༜༝༞༟༠༡༢༣༣༥༦༧༨༩༊་༌།" applies the Bhagavān title to the Hūṃkāra rather than to Vairocana at the moment of slaying — this is textually consistent within the tantra, where the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi in his Hūṃkāra aspect is at times addressed with this epithet. The translation renders this faithfully.

The phrase rendered "cuts through the heart of" literally means "is like a heart-enemy to" all malevolent sentient beings — that is, it strikes at their very core. The rendering preserves the idiomatic force.

- The title "འཇམ་མཉམ་པའི་ཡུལ་" is rendered "Sovereign of Ash," a buddha-name prophesied for Śiva (Maheśvara), playing on his traditional iconographic association with ash. The world-realm "འཇམ་མཉམ་པའི་ཡུལ་" is accordingly "a world-realm covered in ash," consistent with this. The phrase "འཇམ་མཉམ་པའི་ཡུལ་" in the line concerning the bodhisattva who beholds the master of all Tathāgatas is somewhat ambiguous — it could refer to Vajrapāṇi in his aspect as Mahāśvara, or to a distinct figure; the context suggests it is Vajrapāṇi himself in that epithet. The final injunction — never to speak to others of the teacher-gift — likely refers to a tantric secrecy obligation regarding the specific offering or perhaps the manner of Śiva's subjugation; its precise doctrinal import is left implicit in the text.
- The phrase rendered "took her leave with the Blessed One's permission" translates a formulaic expression meaning the assembly requested permission to depart and was granted it; this is a standard narrative closure in tantric sūtra literature.

The passage's depiction of the Blessed One placing the goddess on his thighs and declaring her the "great goddess of the vajra lineage of all the tathāgatas" reflects a tantric empowerment rite in which a consort is formally consecrated; the doctrinal register here is Vajrayāna, not the standard Mahāyāna sūtra context.

- The phrase rendered "outer goddess of form" translates "འཇམ་མཉམ་པའི་ཡུལ་" which is genuinely difficult. The text seems to describe Vairocana entering into or inhabiting the body of the goddess in an outer, formal, or manifest aspect. This is a tantric narrative convention in which a deity takes up residence in a consort's body; the translation renders the most natural reading, but the precise technical nuance of "འཇམ་མཉམ་པའི་ཡུལ་" (outer mode or external form) may carry a more specific doctrinal sense in the original ritual context.
- The name rendered "Vajra-Grace" translates Vajra-sgeg-mo, where sgeg-mo means graceful, elegant, or coquettish. "Vajra-Dance" translates rDo-rje gar-ma. These are two distinct goddesses. The passage's conferral of the name "Vajra-Grace" on the beautiful goddess just empowered, and then the immediate summoning of Vajra-Dance to make a formal declaration, is somewhat abrupt in the source; the translation follows the Tibetan syntax closely.

The epithet "Padmabhava" here renders Pad-mo'i lus-can, literally "one possessing a lotus body," which likely refers to a deity or class of deity associated with the lotus family rather than the figure Padmasambhava; it is used here as a proper name or class descriptor for whoever heads that particular group.

- The mantra passage is rendered in a phonetically reconstructed Sanskrit transcription following the Tibetan syllabic transliteration. Certain syllables are ambiguous and the reconstruction involves editorial judgment; the forms given represent the most plausible Sanskrit readings.

The phrase rendered as "sovereign of all sentient beings who follows after" is based on the Tibetan "rjes su byed ma," meaning "one who acts in accordance with" or "who attends upon" — here interpreted as "sovereign who acts for the benefit of all sentient beings," which fits the context of the epithets. This is a mildly uncertain rendering.

The passage is mid-sentence at the end, broken off at "yakṣas, rākṣasas, and" — the source text stops there and the translation reflects that exact break.

- The phrase rendered "eaten by a great flesh-devouring creature" translates a term that literally means "a great predator that has consumed someone" — the exact animal is

unspecified in the Tibetan; the rendering preserves that openness. The repeated phrase "he will die — indeed, he will die again and again" reflects a Tibetan construction that emphasizes the certainty and finality of the killing by doubling the statement. The passage's frank enumeration of harmful and erotic applications alongside protective and healing ones is characteristic of early tantric ritual manuals and is rendered faithfully without softening.

- The passage employs the Sanskrit loanwords bhaga and bindu untranslated, as they function as technical tantric terms throughout: bhaga refers to the female generative organ as a locus of ritual and meditative practice in this context, and bindu to the seminal or luminous essence central to Vajrayāna physiology. Rendering them into English equivalents would distort their technical register.

The phrase rendered "from that milk" translates the Tibetan literally; the referent is the lunar nectar or white bodhicitta produced in the visualization, a standard Vajrayāna physiological-contemplative image.

The figure of the "lotus growing in the sky" is an established Indian logical trope for an absolute impossibility, used here to underscore why external visualization alone cannot yield awakening.

- The term bhaga throughout this passage refers to the female sexual organ in its tantric ritual context. The text is part of a yoginītantra or related genre in which sexual yoga is described explicitly, and the translation preserves this without euphemism, consistent with the doctrinal and textual register.

The phrase rendered "king of mantras" refers to the practitioner's root or principal mantra, a standard tantric usage.

"Vajra Dancer" renders rdo rje gar ma, a specific tantric deity; no Sanskrit reconstruction is securely available beyond the Tibetan itself.

"Vajrahūṃkāra" is a specific wrathful deity of the Vajrayāna pantheon; the Tibetan rdo rje hūṃ mdzad is retained in Sanskrit form as is conventional.

The "Lord of the World" glossing Avalokiteśvara here follows the Tibetan 'jig rten dbang phyug, a standard epithet of Avalokiteśvara in this literature.

- The terms cūṣaṇa, āliṅga, and bhaga are Sanskrit technical terms from the tantric context that appear in the Tibetan in phonetic transcription. Cūṣaṇa refers to a practice of "sucking" or "drawing up" vital essence through channels; āliṅga means "embrace"; bhaga refers to the female generative organ as a ritual locus. These terms are left in their Sanskrit forms as they appear in the source and their explicit translation would be inappropriate for a general audience without substantial commentary.

The phrase rendered "oneself black in color" with "the form of the dark channel" reflects an ambiguity in the Tibetan, where the dark channel and the black visualization of Vajrahūṃkāra may be intended as distinct instructions sequenced together, or as a single composite visualization. The rendering follows the most natural syntactic reading.

- The passage describes a vivid tantric scene involving union practices and wrathful visualization. The terms "cūṣaṇa" and "āliṅga" (rendered as "embrace" and "clasping") are technical Sanskrit terms for specific tantric embrace practices; the Tibetan preserves the Sanskrit phonetically. The phrase rendered "intimate union with a woman, the cūṣaṇa and so forth" follows the literal Tibetan which specifies female consort practice as the prerequisite offering for transmission.

The figure "Vajra Hūṃkāra" is a wrathful tantric deity whose name is preserved from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of the Sanskrit; this is the deity Vajrahūṃkāra, a wrathful form used in protective and destructive visualization practices.

The count "two thousand five hundred queens, each of five hundred thrones" represents a literal rendering of the Tibetan arithmetic; the passage describes five hundred groups of five hundred queens each, totaling two thousand five hundred — though the syntax allows for alternative readings.

- The term rendered "essence-extraction" translates *bcud len*, a tantric and medical practice of sustained nourishment through subtle means, sometimes involving alchemical or yogic substances rather than ordinary food. The passage shifts between literal dietary prescription and subtle yogic practice; the final portion is clearly a sexual-yogic instruction within the tantric framework of this text. The *srang* is a traditional Tibetan unit of weight; it is left as "srang" since no single English equivalent is standard in this literature, though it approximates a tael or roughly thirty-five grams. The phrase "unyoked from the wind" in the driving-away visualization reflects a subtle-body doctrine in which the goddess is conceived as operating independently of the wind-energies, making the dispersal instantaneous. The text breaks off mid-sentence at the close, consistent with the passage being a continuation to the next section.
- The term "bhaga" is retained untranslated throughout, as it is a Sanskrit technical term used in the Tibetan text itself in transliteration, referring to the female sexual organ in its ritual-tantric sense. Rendering it otherwise would obscure the technical register the text itself maintains.

The phrase "Sovereigns of the Yoginīs" renders "rnal 'byor ma'i dbang phyug," the feminine form, while "Sovereigns of Yoga" at the opening renders the masculine or general form "rnal 'byor gyi dbang phyug"; the distinction is maintained accordingly.

"Īśvara, the Lord of the World" renders "'jig rten dbang phyug," a standard epithet that can refer to Avalokiteśvara or to a general lord-of-the-world figure; the context here groups it among male tantric deity-bodies, so it is left as a general epithet rather than identified with Avalokiteśvara specifically.

The final sentence is left open as in the Tibetan, which breaks off mid-clause continuing into the next passage.

- The text names two plants, "atibalā" and "mahābalā," which are Ayurvedic herbs known in Sanskrit by those names and are left untranslated as proper botanical names. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, exactly as the Tibetan does; no text has been supplied.
- The colophon names two translators: one whose name contains the epithet Sugata rendered here as "Bde-bzar-gslegs-pa'i-dpal" (meaning "Glorious Sugata" or "Glory of the Sugata"), and Dra-rig Kunga Gyaltsen (Skt. Śabdavidyā Ānandadhvaṇa). The exact historical identification of the first named translator is uncertain from the text alone; his name is rendered descriptively in the verse line to preserve the meter and meaning without invention.

The term "bindu" (Tibetan *thig le*) is retained in the title translation as it is a standard tantric technical term; it refers here to the "supreme sphere" or "supreme drop" of secret essence.

The phrase "lunar maṇḍala of sandalwood" renders *tsan dan la zla ba'i dkyil 'khor*, meaning a maṇḍala of sandalwood fashioned in the form of, or bearing the symbol of, the moon disc — a standard ritual support for receiving a master.

Colophon

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human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.